

NAXALISM ACROSS INDIA: AN OSINT COMPREHENSIVE STUDY



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IMBA – Sem 3, 30008



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Introduction:



Figure 1: (Visual Reference)

1.1 What is Naxilism?

Left Wing Extremism (LWE), often referred to as **Naxalism**, is one of India's most serious **internal security challenges**.

Rooted in socio-economic inequalities and fueled by Maoist ideology, LWE has historically affected some of the most remote, underdeveloped, and tribal-

dominated regions of the country. The movement has aimed to undermine the Indian state through armed **rebellion** and **parallel governance structures**, particularly targeting security forces, public infrastructure, and democratic institutions. Originating from the **Naxalbari movement** of **1967** in **West Bengal**, it spread primarily across the "**Red Corridor**," affecting states

like **Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha, Maharashtra, Kerala, West Bengal, Madhya Pradesh**, and parts of **Andhra Pradesh** and **Telangana**. The Maoist insurgents claim to fight for the rights of the marginalized, particularly tribal communities, but their methods include armed violence, extortion, destruction of infrastructure, and recruitment of children and civilians.

However, in recent years, India's **multidimensional counter-LWE strategy** - combining security enforcement, inclusive development, and community engagement - has delivered significant success. The movement has been **systematically weakened**, **violence** has **drastically declined**, and many LWE-affected districts are being **reintegrated** into the **national mainstream**. The government of India is committed to **completely eliminate Naxalism by 31st March 2026**, since Naxalism is seen as the biggest obstacle in the development of remote areas and tribal villages, as it prevents education, healthcare, connectivity, banking, and postal services from reaching these villages.

Source: <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2120771>

1.2 Red Corridor

The Maoist insurgency expanded across what is commonly called the “Red Corridor,” a vast swathe of territory stretching through Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha, Bihar, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, and parts of Madhya Pradesh and West Bengal. This region overlaps heavily with tribal-dominated districts rich in minerals, forests, and water resources, but paradoxically marked by underdevelopment, displacement, and exploitation. The Maoists exploited these conditions, positioning themselves as protectors of tribal rights while simultaneously recruiting children, levying “revolutionary taxes,” and committing violent attacks.

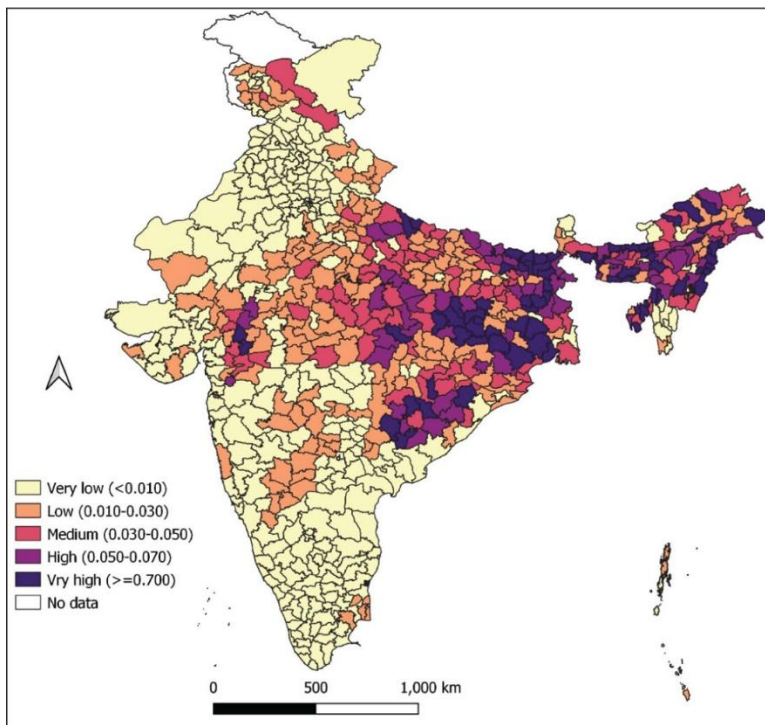
At its peak in the early 2010s, nearly 200 districts across India were affected by LWE, making it one of the most serious threats to India’s internal stability and development. Violence included ambushes on security forces, assassinations of political leaders, and the destruction of schools, roads, and communication infrastructure to isolate communities from state institutions.



1.3 Socio-Economic Roots of the Insurgency

The resilience of Naxalism has been deeply tied to socio-economic grievances. Widespread poverty, low literacy rates, unemployment, and land alienation created fertile ground for Maoist propaganda. Tribals in particular faced large-scale displacement due to mining and infrastructure projects without adequate compensation or rehabilitation. In many villages, the absence of schools, healthcare, banking, and reliable roads made the state almost invisible, while the Maoists filled the vacuum with parallel governance and coercive influence. For many locals, the only visible representatives of the government were armed police or forest officials, leading to deep distrust of state authority.

This socio-economic disconnect explains why, despite years of counterinsurgency operations, the movement found safe havens in remote forested areas where governance was minimal and development schemes rarely reached.



The map in Figure 1 provides a clear visual of the development gaps across India. States like Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, and Odisha—areas long affected by Naxalism—display lower human development indices. Such administrative neglect and deprivation have created fertile ground for insurgency. This map, sourced from publicly accessible academic literature, reinforces the argument that socio-economic deprivation is central to understanding the insurgency's persistence.

Figure 2: Relative human development levels across Indian states, illustrating how socio-economic deprivation aligns with regions historically influenced by Left-Wing Extremism (LWE).

1.4 Government Response and Strategy



Figure 4: (Visual Reference)

Over the last two decades, the Government of India has adopted a multidimensional strategy to combat Naxalism. Security enforcement has been strengthened through specialized paramilitary units such as the CRPF's CoBRA battalion and state-level commando forces like the Greyhounds in Andhra Pradesh and Telangana. Coordination between central and state police forces has been improved, while modern technologies like drones and satellite imagery are increasingly used for surveillance and tracking Maoist activities.

At the same time, the government recognized that the conflict cannot be

solved through force alone. Development programs have been accelerated under schemes like the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (rural roads), expansion of mobile connectivity, banking and postal services in tribal belts, and initiatives to improve healthcare and education in remote areas. The rehabilitation and surrender policy has also encouraged many Maoist cadres to rejoin mainstream society, providing financial assistance, housing, and employment training.

This twin approach of “security and development” has yielded results. The number of LWE-affected districts has steadily declined, violence has dropped, and several states once considered Maoist strongholds now report only sporadic incidents. The Government of India has publicly committed to eliminating Naxalism by 31st March 2026, describing it as the biggest obstacle to development in tribal areas.

1.5 OSINT Scope of this Report

This report has been prepared using **Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT)** methods. Information was gathered from publicly accessible government documents (such as PIB press releases), independent research organizations (notably the South Asia Terrorism Portal, SATP), academic writings, and credible news reports. Comparative maps of LWE-affected districts before and after 2010s were sourced from SATP archives, while statistical data on violence was retrieved from government press releases available through targeted Google Dorking. By combining these open sources, the report provides both a quantitative and qualitative understanding of the decline of Naxalism between 2022 and 2024.

This approach demonstrates how OSINT tools can be effectively leveraged to analyze internal security trends without relying on classified data, making the findings transparent, verifiable, and accessible for researchers, policymakers, and the general public.

Sources(OSINT): PIB, SATP, MHA reports, NCRB, and open-source news articles



2. Historical Evolution of Naxalism in India:

(Just for visual reference)

Phase 1: Ideological Roots and Birth of the Movement (Pre-1967 – 1969)

- **Pre-1960s:** The ideological foundation of Naxalism lay in **Marxist-Leninist** principles, which took root in India after independence through the Communist Party of India (CPI). Discontent grew among peasants and tribal communities facing **feudal oppression, bonded labor, and landlessness**.
 - **1964:** A split within the CPI led to the formation of the **Communist Party of India (Marxist)** or CPI(M), which contained both parliamentary and revolutionary factions.
 - **1967:**
 - **Naxalbari Uprising (Darjeeling district, West Bengal):** Led by Charu Majumdar, Kanu Sanyal, and Jangal Santhal, a group of armed peasants attacked landlords, seized crops, and redistributed land.
 - The uprising was inspired by Mao Zedong's model of **protracted people's war**.
 - The death of a police sub-inspector in a confrontation triggered a severe police crackdown.
 - **1969:** Formation of the **Communist Party of India (Marxist–Leninist) [CPI(ML)]** by Charu Majumdar, formalizing the armed struggle.
-

Phase 2: Early Expansion and State Crackdown (1970 – 1980)

- **1970–1972:**
 - The CPI(ML) expanded activities in West Bengal, Bihar, Andhra Pradesh, and parts of Uttar Pradesh.
 - Majumdar promoted the “annihilation line”, targeted killings of class enemies, especially landlords and police informants.
 - Charu Majumdar was arrested in 1972 and died in custody, causing a leadership vacuum.
 - **Mid-1970s:**
 - The movement splintered into multiple factions after internal disagreements.
 - Increased **counter-insurgency operations** by state police forces pushed Naxals underground.
 - **Late 1970s:** Some factions began to focus on **long-term mass mobilization** rather than immediate armed struggle, learning from the failures of the early years.
-

Phase 3: Consolidation into Regional Powerhouses (1980 – 2003)

- **1980:** Formation of the **People’s War Group (PWG)** in Andhra Pradesh under Kondapalli Seetharamaiah, focusing on guerrilla warfare and building “liberated zones.”
- **1980s–1990s:**
 - **Maoist Communist Centre (MCC)** rose in Bihar and Jharkhand, specializing in mine warfare and ambushes.
 - The PWG spread influence into Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh, and Orissa.
 - Naxals began targeting **infrastructure** : railways, schools, telephone lines to hinder state penetration.
 - “Janatana Sarkars” (people’s governments) were established in remote forest areas.

- **1990s:**
 - The insurgency became **better armed** with automatic weapons looted from security forces.
 - Recruitment from tribal communities surged due to **land alienation and mining-related displacement**.
 - By late 1990s, both PWG and MCC became dominant players, each controlling significant pockets of rural India.
-

Phase 4: Merger, Peak Violence, and National Response (2004 – 2014)

- **2004:** The PWG and MCC merged to form the **Communist Party of India (Maoist)**, marking the most significant unification in the movement's history.
 - **2005:**
 - Launch of **Salwa Judum** in Chhattisgarh, A controversial state-backed vigilante movement to counter Maoists.
 - Salwa Judum's human rights abuses led to widespread criticism and its eventual banning by the Supreme Court in 2011.
 - **2009:**
 - The Government of India launched **Operation Green Hunt**, a massive joint operation involving CRPF, state police, and intelligence agencies.
 - Violence peaked here, large-scale attacks on police convoys and camps became frequent.
 - **2010:**
 - **Dantewada massacre:** 76 CRPF personnel killed in a single ambush in Chhattisgarh.
 - Naxals demonstrated advanced ambush tactics and use of IEDs (Improvised Explosive Devices).
 - **2010–2014:**
 - The insurgency controlled or influenced nearly **96 districts** in 10 states.
 - Attacks targeted political leaders, infrastructure projects, and mining operations.
-

Phase 5: Decline and Strategic Retreat (2015 – Present)

- **2015–2019:**
 - Coordinated **security offensives**, improved **human intelligence (HUMINT)**, and better **road and telecom connectivity** weakened Maoist influence.
 - Several senior leaders, including **Kishenji (2011)** and **Hidma’s deputies**, were killed or captured.
- **2020–2022:**
 - Naxals faced logistical issues during COVID-19 lockdowns.
 - The insurgency shrank to under **50 affected districts**.
- **2023–2025:**
 - According to the Ministry of Home Affairs, only **three states (Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha)** now have severely affected pockets.
 - The Government of India announced a **target to eliminate Naxalism by March 31, 2026**.
 - Recent operations in **Bastar (2024)** and **Gadchiroli (2025)** indicate that while weakened, the Maoists retain the ability to mount **sporadic high-impact attacks**.

Period	Key Events	Source
1967–1969	Naxalbari uprising; CPI(ML) formation; “Historic Eight Documents”	https://ijcrt.org/papers/IJCRT2402070.pdf
1970–1980	Majumdar’s arrest & fragmentation	Homegrown.co.in
1980–2003	Rise of PWG, MCC, guerrilla zones	(Wikipedia)
2004–2014	Merger into CPI(Maoist), peak insurgency across districts	(Financial Times)
2015–2024	Substantial decline — districts, incidents, and casualties	(Press Information Bureau, The Times of India)

To enhance the search result, have used one of the refined OSINT method Google Dorking.

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intext:'Naxalbari uprising' 'Historic Eight Documents' filetype:pdf

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He strengthened the Naxalite movement through his writings, the most famous being the 'Historic Eight Documents' which formed the basis of Naxalite ideology. In 1967 the 'Naxalites' organized th...

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THE NAXALBARI MOVEMENT - JSTOR
article is an attempt to review the politics of the C.P.I. (M-L), or the **Naxalite** politics, to use the common parlance - the most radical and militant stream of left politics in India in general, and...

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LWE part - 1 - studyiq.net
Term '**Naxal**' derives its name from the village **Naxalbari** of district Darjeeling in West Bengal, where the movement originated in 1967 under the leadership of Charu Majumdar and Kanu Sanyal. Aim: ...

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Naxalism: The Left-Wing Extremist Movement in India
In 1967, the **Naxalite insurgency** was initiated as a radical protest by the oppressed peasants against the colonial tenancy system retained by the feudal landowners even after the British had le...

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INTRODUCTION :
Naxalbari uprising was an armed peasant revolt in 1967 in the Naxalbari block of Siliguri subdivision in Darjeeling district, West Bengal, India. It was mainly led by tribals and the radical communist leaders of Bengal and further developed into the Communist Party of India (Marxist-Leninist) in 1969. The armed struggle became an inspiration to the Naxalite movement which rapidly spread from West Bengal to other states of India creating division within the CPI(M) - India's primary communist party.
The term 'Naxalite' comes from Naxalbari, a small village in West Bengal, where an extremist section of Communist Party of India (Marxist) [CPI (M)] led by Charu Majumder and Kanu Sanyal organised a violent peasant uprising in 1967, trying to develop a 'revolutionary opposition' against the CPI (M) leadership. The insurrection started on May 25, 1967 in Naxalbari village when a farmer was attacked by local goons over a

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land dispute. Maoists in the guise of local farmers retaliated by attacking the local landlords and escalated the violence. Majumder greatly admired Mao Ze-dong of China and advocated that Indian peasants and lower classes must follow in his footsteps and overthrow the government and upper classes whom he held responsible for their plight. He strengthened the Naxalite movement through his writings, the most famous being the 'Historic Eight Documents' which formed the basis of Naxalite ideology. In 1967 the 'Naxalites' organized the All-India Coordination Committee of Communist.

CAUSE OF THE UPRISING :
May, 1967 an agrarian movement broke out at Naxalbari and its adjoining areas on the outskirts of Siliguri of the northern part of Bengal known as Naxalbari Movement, which rocked the whole world. The local

2.

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The Political History Of Charu Majumdar Naxalite Movement I ...

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At the time of emergency, he was **captured** from his Calcutta hide-out on July 16, 1972 by Runu Guha Niyogi (Detective Department) and killed in police custody at Alipore Central Jail on July 28,...

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the CPI(ML).

With Charu Majumdar's demise, a vibrant chapter in India's revolutionary movement came to a close. The central authority of the CPI(ML) collapsed, and the peasant struggle suffered a severe setback. Although the ultra-leftist movement has witnessed numerous ideological divisions since the late 1970s, the spirit of Naxalism continues to influence a multitude of ultra-left groups across the globe; shaping the discourse on [revolution](#) and social justice.

His comrades viewed Charu's death as a great tragedy while those from the other camp took it as a grandiose win for the government. The idea is not to ask you to pick sides in this battle but rather to introspect. A wealthy young man abandons his life of [privilege](#) only to choose a life filled with a constant fear of incarceration, tirelessly working with the exploited working class of the nation even amidst failing health and eventually succumbing to barbaric torture and undignified death. Was his method justified? Maybe yes. Maybe no. Was his revolution successful? History suggests otherwise. Was he a champion of the masses or a traitor to the state? This writing is not propaganda and so it is not my place to answer that question but rather for you to decide.

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timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/kochi/maoist-conflicts-caused-5344-deaths-since-2004/articleshow/55610771.cms

TOI City Kochi Mumbai Delhi Bengaluru Hyderabad Kolkata Chennai Agra Agartala Ahmedabad Ajmer Allahabad

THIS STORY IS FROM NOVEMBER 25, 2016

Maoist conflicts caused 5,344 deaths since 2004

Shenoy Karun / TNN / Nov 25, 2016, 06:17 IST

CPI (Maoist) was formed in September 2004 with the merger of People's War Group (PWG) and Maoist Communist Centre (MCC), two rebel groups that were acting independently till then.



(Representative image)

KOCHI: Since the formation of the Communist Party of India (Maoist) in 2004, the total death toll of its armed conflicts has touched 5,344, revealed a Swedish database on armed conflicts. Of this, 3,687 happened during the conflicts between CPI (Maoist) and the state forces. The rest, 1,657 civilians, were killed by the one-sided attack launched by CPI (Maoists), the database showed.

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Nationality Question in India The stand of Our Party

The Central Committee of the CPI (Maoist) wrote the document 'Nationality Question in India – The stand of our Party' and released it on 2019 May 26th. Later the CC received certain suggestions,...

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The Marxist Volume: 03, No. 1 January-March, 1985 Naxalism ...

Even before the announcement of the formation of the CPI(ML) in 1969, the splintering had begun. In 1968 when the various naxalite groups which split away from the CPI(M) formed the All India...

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THE NAXALITES: INDIA'S EXTREME LEFT-WING COMMUNISTS

THE NAXALITES: INDIA'S EXTREME LEFT-WING COMMUNISTS

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South Asia Multidisciplinary Academic Journal, 7 | 2013

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SHRI NARENDRA MODI
HAZARIBAGH, JHARKHAND

October 2, 2024, PM Narendra Modi launched the 'Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan' from Jharkhand. This campaign will be a milestone in **providing personal amenities** for achieving full saturation in rural areas in **over 15,000 villages**, benefiting nearly **1.5 crore people** in **LWE affected areas**. The government is strengthening 3-C i.e., **Road connectivity, Mobile connectivity and Financial connectivity** in the LWE affected areas.

Success Stories

As part of **zero-tolerance policy** against Naxalism, **90 Naxals** have been killed, **104 arrested**, and **164 have surrendered** in the year, **by March 2025**. In 2024, **290 Naxalites** were **neutralized**, **1,090** were **arrested**, and **881 surrendered**.

Recently on **30th March 2025**, **50 Naxalites** in **Bijapur (Chhattisgarh)** **surrendered**. On **29th March 2025**, our security agencies **neutralised 16 Naxalites** and **recovered a massive cache of automatic weapons** in an operation in **Sukma (Chhattisgarh)**. On **20th March 2025**, in two different operations by our security forces in **Bijapur and Kanker, Chhattisgarh**, **22 Naxals** were **killed**, achieving another major success in the '**Naxalmukt Bharat Abhiyan**'.

As per the information shared by the honourable Home Minister, for the **first time in 30 years**, the number of casualties due to LWE was **below 100 in 2022**, which is a significant achievement. From **2014 to 2024**, there has been a **substantial decline** in Naxal-related incidents. **15 top Naxal leaders** have been **neutralized**, and the **government welfare schemes** have been better **implemented** to reach to the last man in the queue. Areas like **Buddha Pahad** and **Chakarbandha** have been **completely free** from the grip of Naxalism. **85% of the LWE cadre strength in Chhattisgarh** has been **eliminated**. Since **January 2024**, a total of **237 Naxalites** have been killed, **812 arrested**, and **723 have surrendered** in Chhattisgarh. More than **13,000 people** from the **Northeast, Kashmir**, and LWE affected areas have **renounced violence** and joined the mainstream.

In 2014, there were **330 police stations** where **Naxal incidents** occurred, but now this number has reduced to **104**. Earlier **Naxal-affected area** was spread in more than **18,000 square kilometers**, now only span **4,200 square kilometers**. Between **2004 and 2014**, there were a total of **16,463 incidents** of Naxal violence. However, during **2014 to 2024**, the number of violent incidents **decreased** by **53%**, dropping to **7,744**. Similarly, the **number of casualties of security forces** decreased by **73%**, from **1,851 to 509**. By 2014, there were a total of **66 fortified police stations**, but over the past 10 years, their number has increased to **612**. In the **past 5 years**, a total of **302 new security camps** and **68 night landing helipads** have been established.

To **financially choke the Naxalites** and break their financial backbone, **National Investigation Agency (NIA)** and **Enforcement Directorate** were used, **seizing several crores of rupees** from Naxalites. Under the **Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA)**, cases were filed, and those who funded the Naxalites were sent behind bars. To bring development to Naxal-affected areas, the **budget allocation** for these regions was **increased by 300%**.

In **December 2023**, within a single year, **380 Naxalites** were **killed**, **1,194** were **arrested**, and **1,045 surrendered**.

2.1 The phases above trace the rise, expansion, and gradual decline of Naxalism in India. Once spread across nearly 96 districts, the insurgency has now contracted to a few pockets in Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, and Odisha.

Below, the **historic satellite images and conflict maps** illustrate this decline. They show how areas once deeply affected by Left-Wing Extremism (LWE) have undergone **visible transformation** — from conflict-ridden zones with minimal infrastructure to regions showing signs of **development, connectivity, and state presence**.

These visuals, sourced through **open-source intelligence (OSINT)** methods such as Google Earth's **historical imagery**

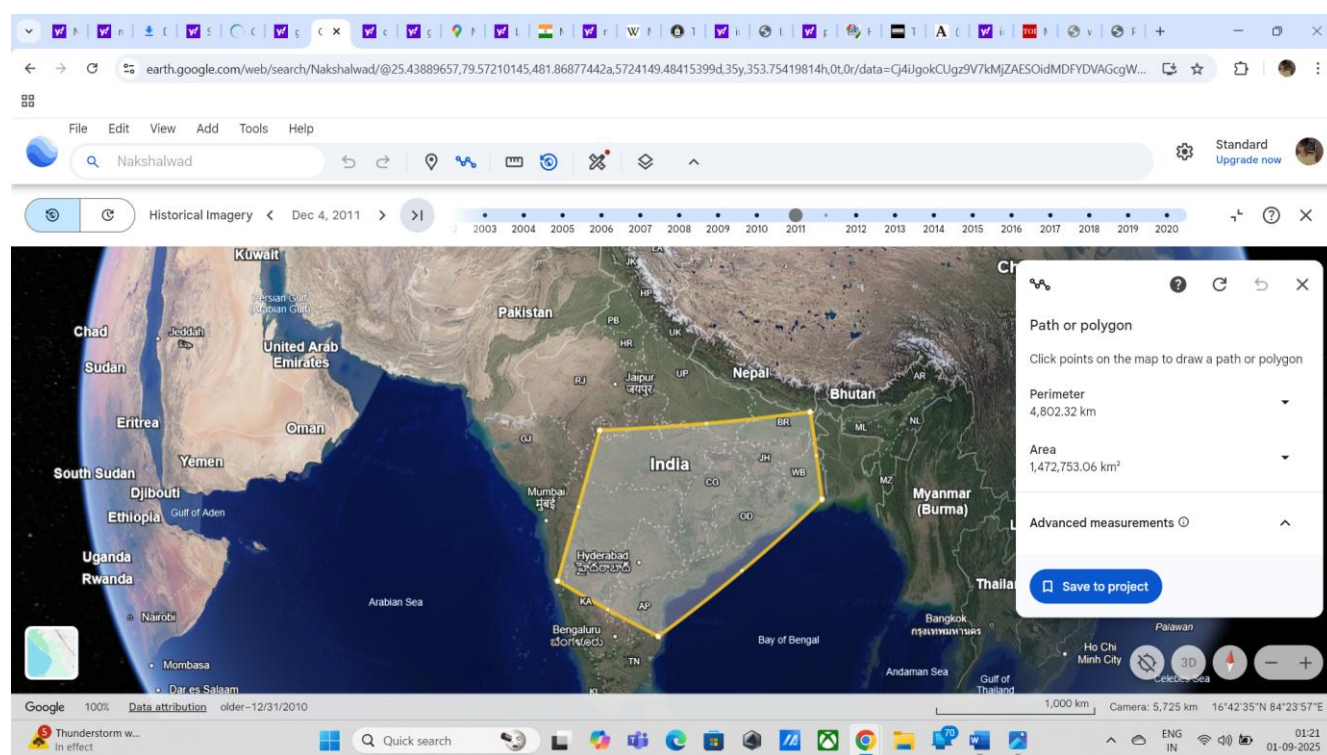


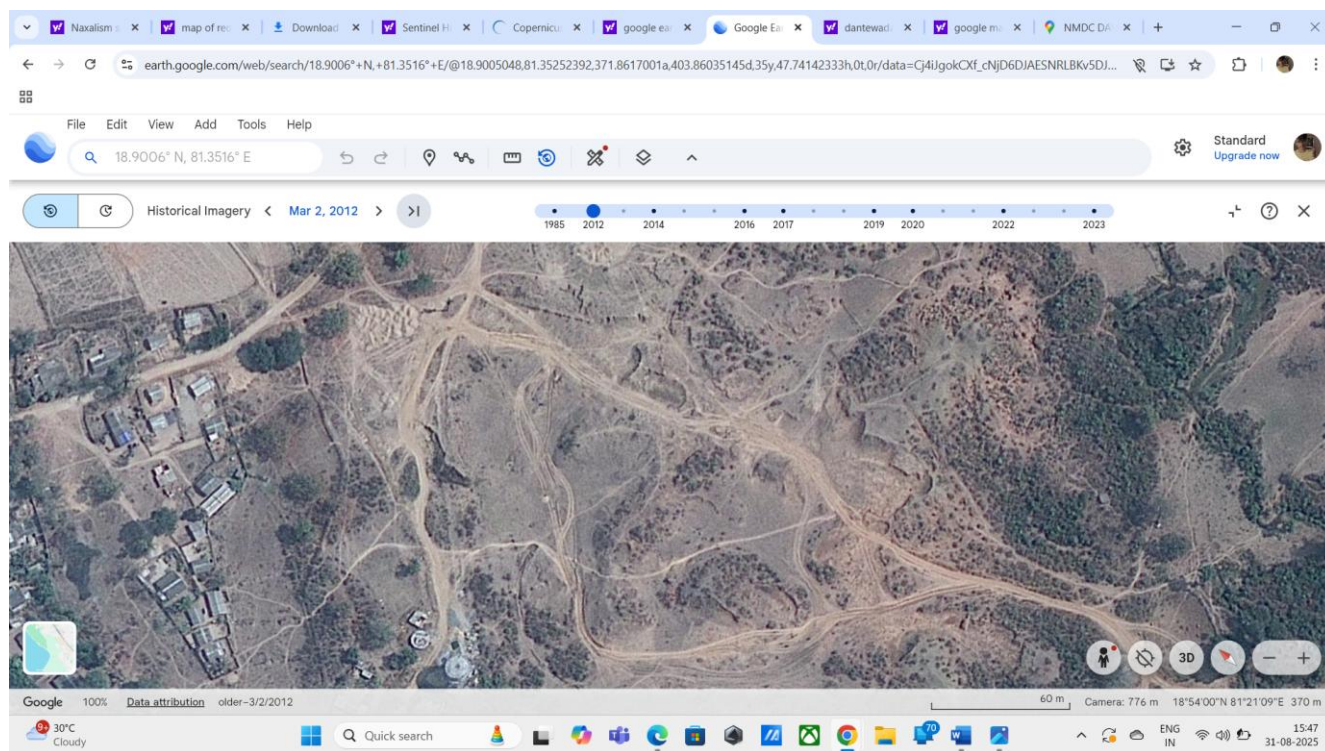
Figure 5 Major Red Corridor

Chhattisgarh (Bastar Division – Core Hotspot)

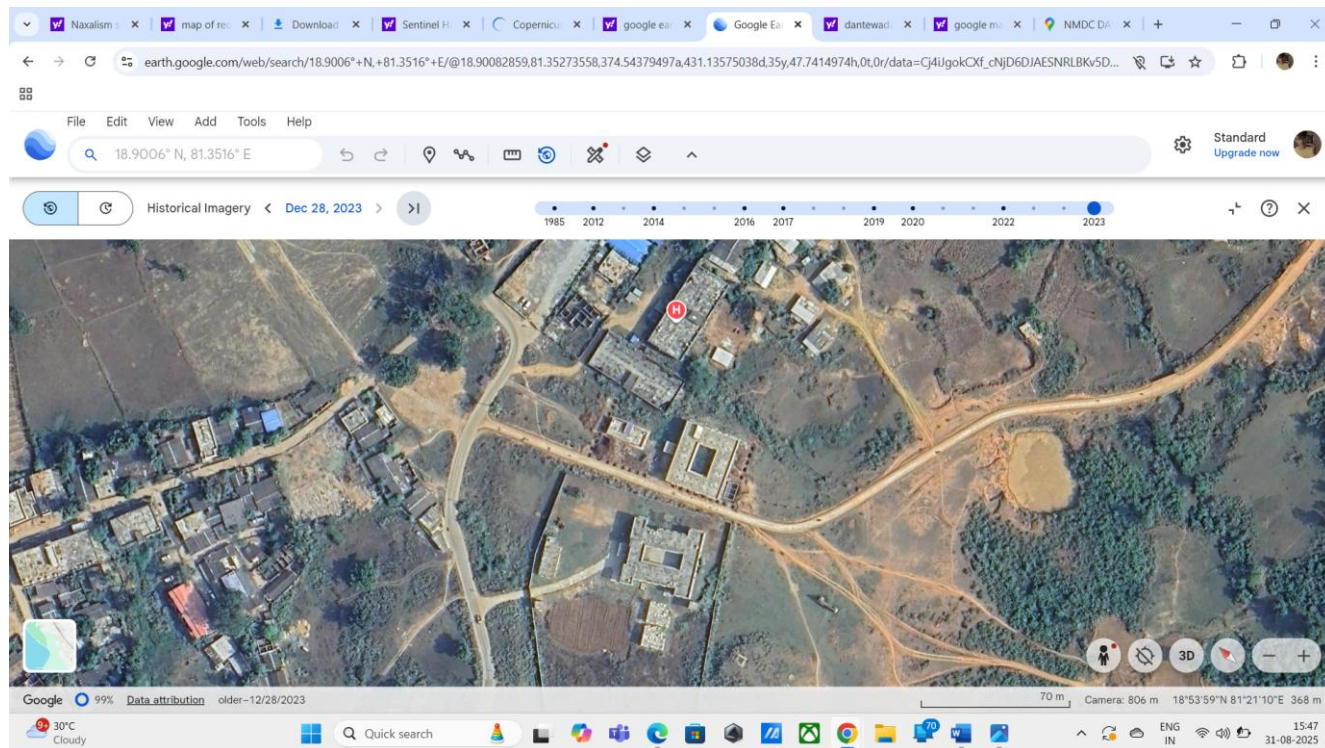
Dantewada:

(Cluster of schools, government buildings, hospital complex)

Before:



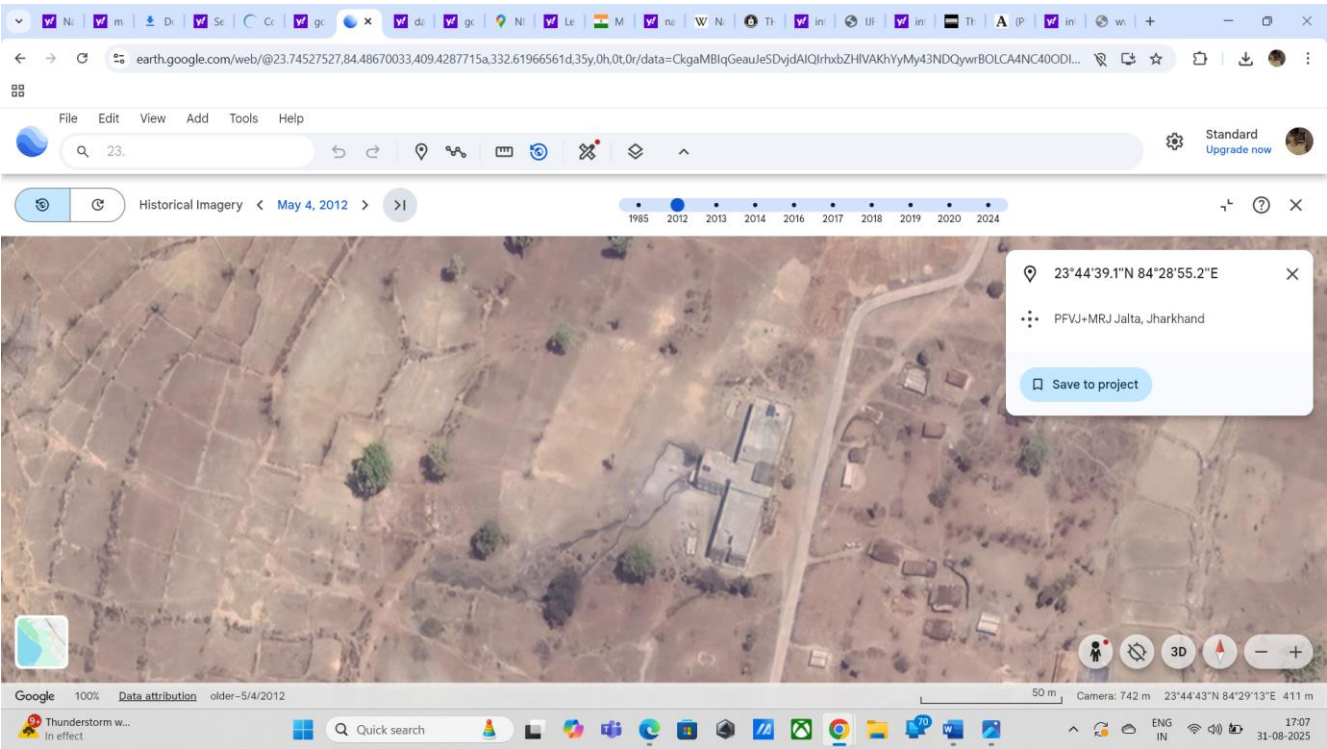
After:



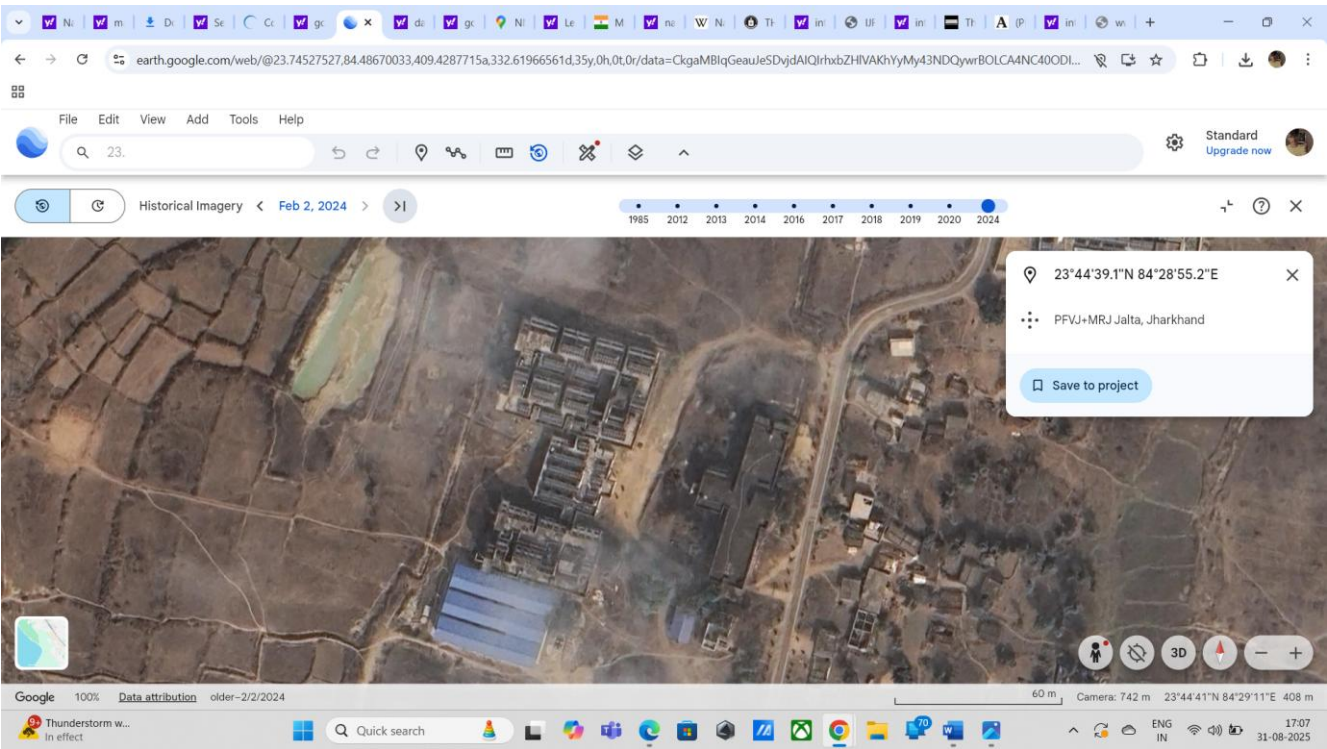
Latehar, Jharkhand:

Coal mines and associated settlements that were once Naxal strongholds

Before:



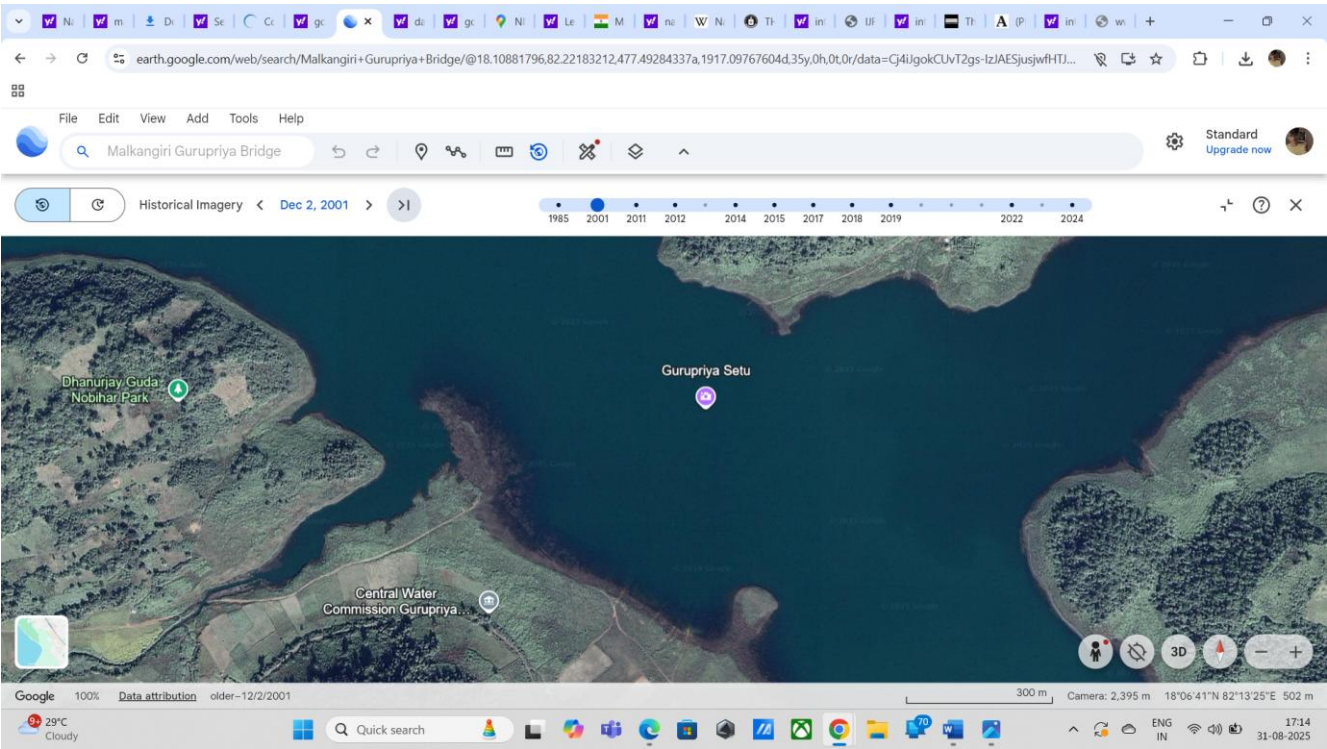
After:



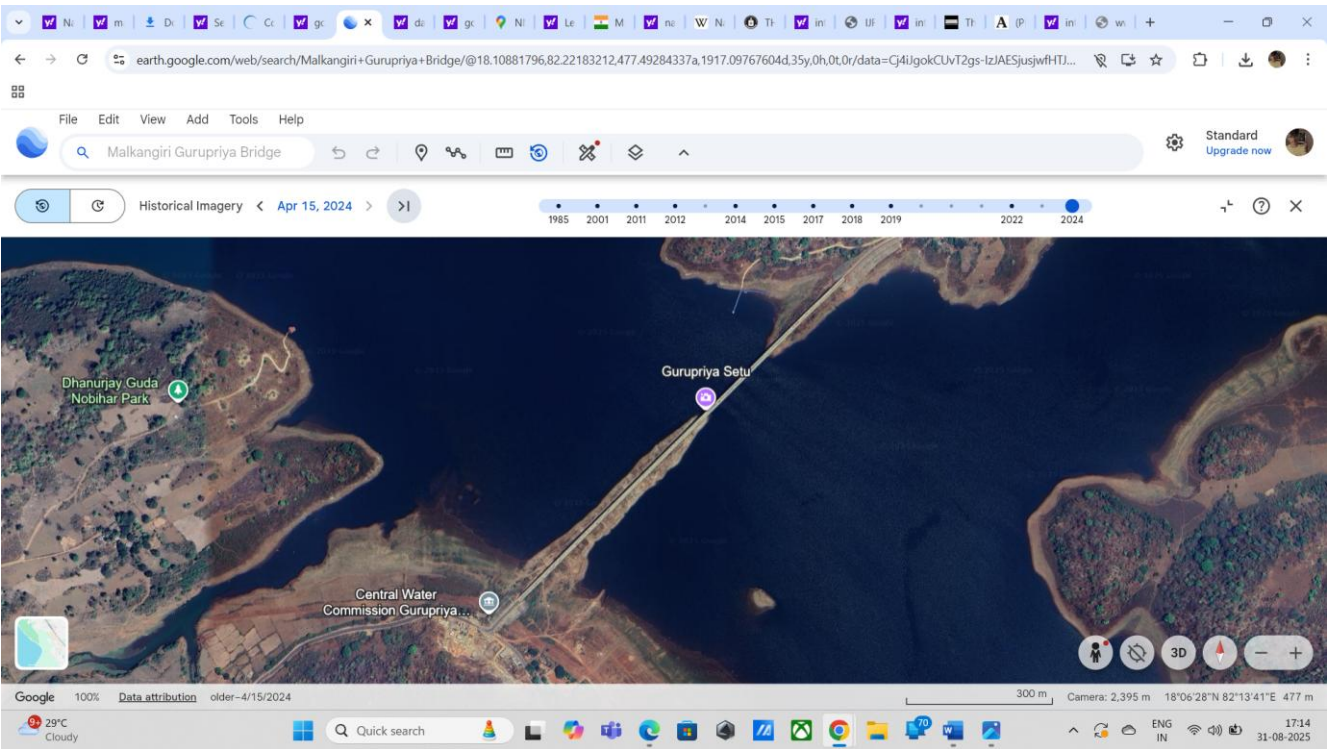
Malkangiri Gurupriya Bridge,Odisha

(A vital bridge that connected cut-off Naxal-affected villages after 50 years)

Before:



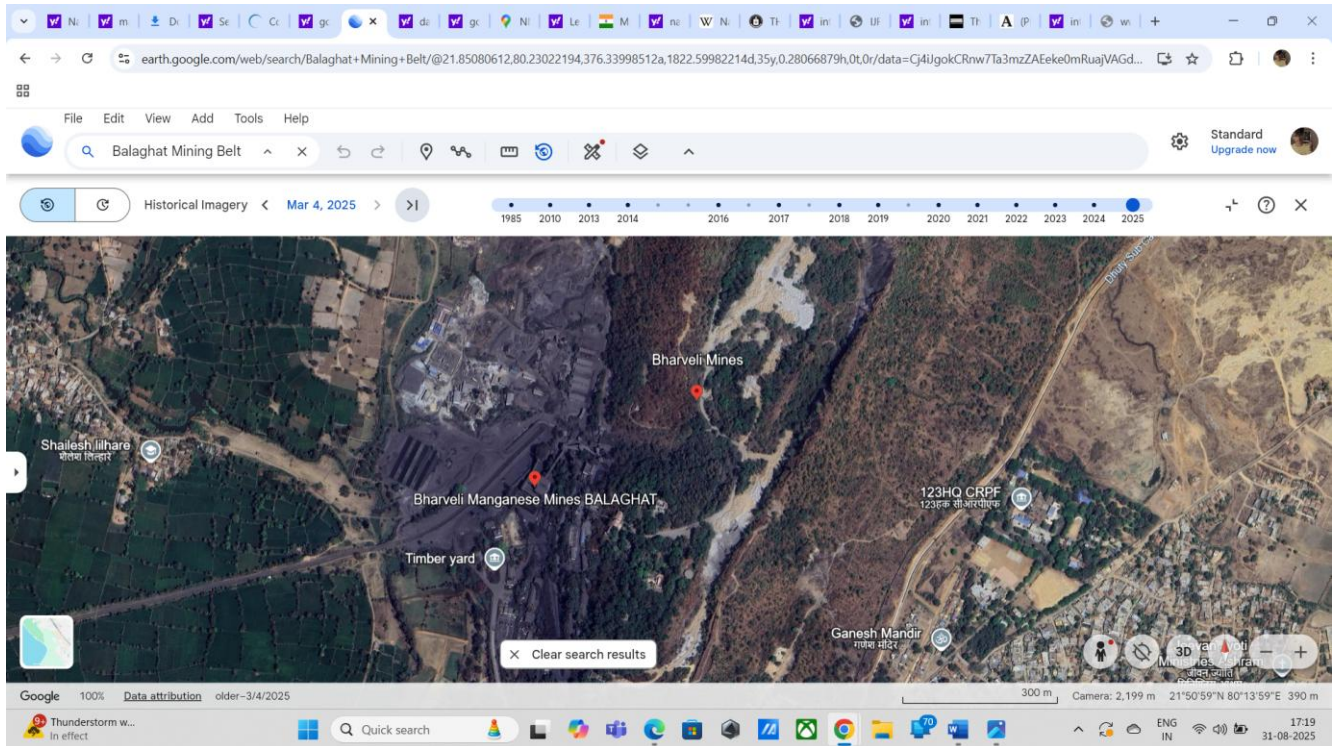
After:



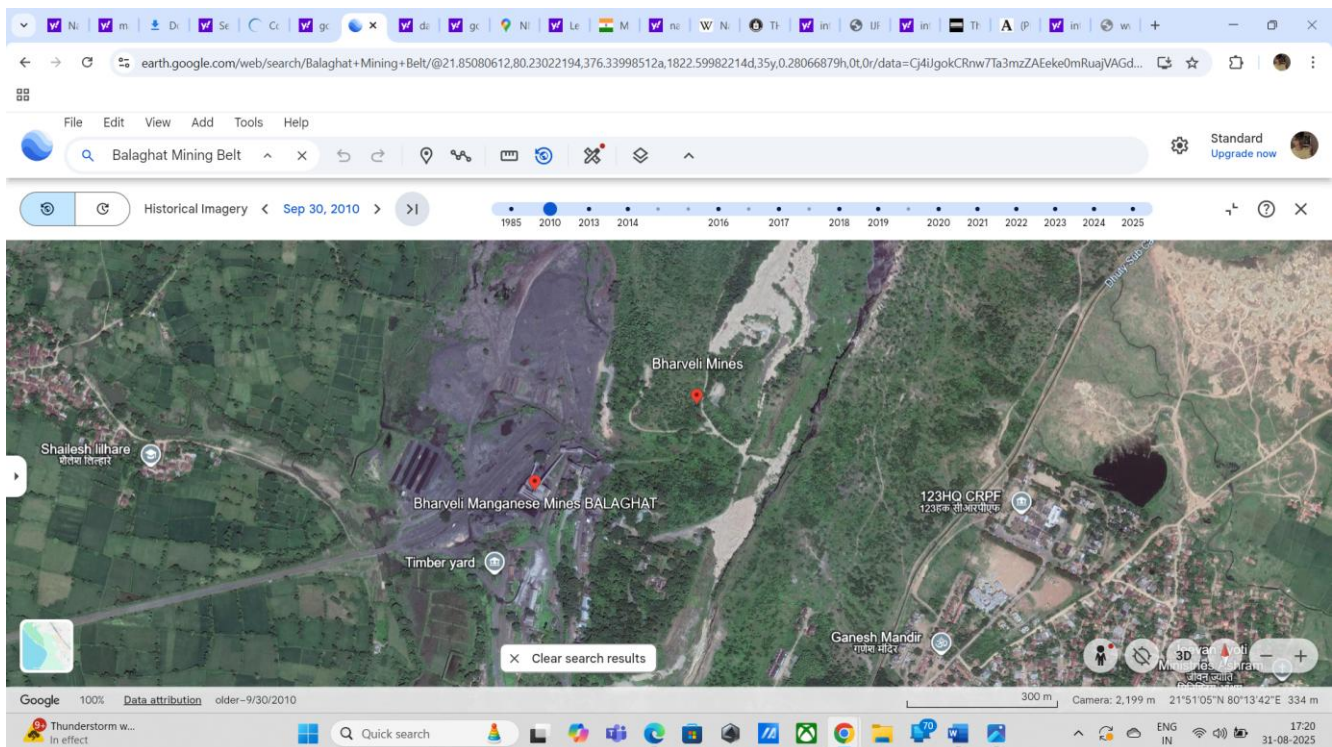
Balaghat Mining Belt, Madhya Pradesh (Naxal-hit Zone)

(Large manganese and copper mining operations, guarded by security)

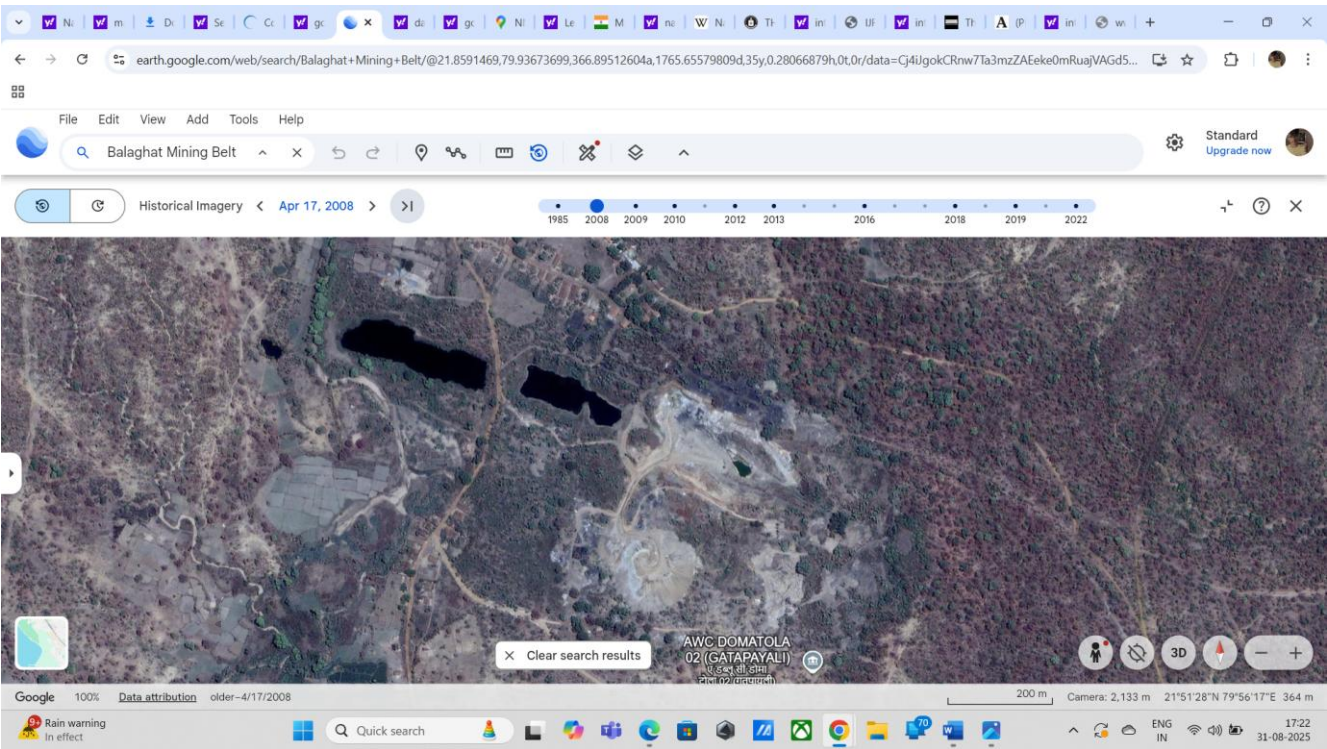
Before:



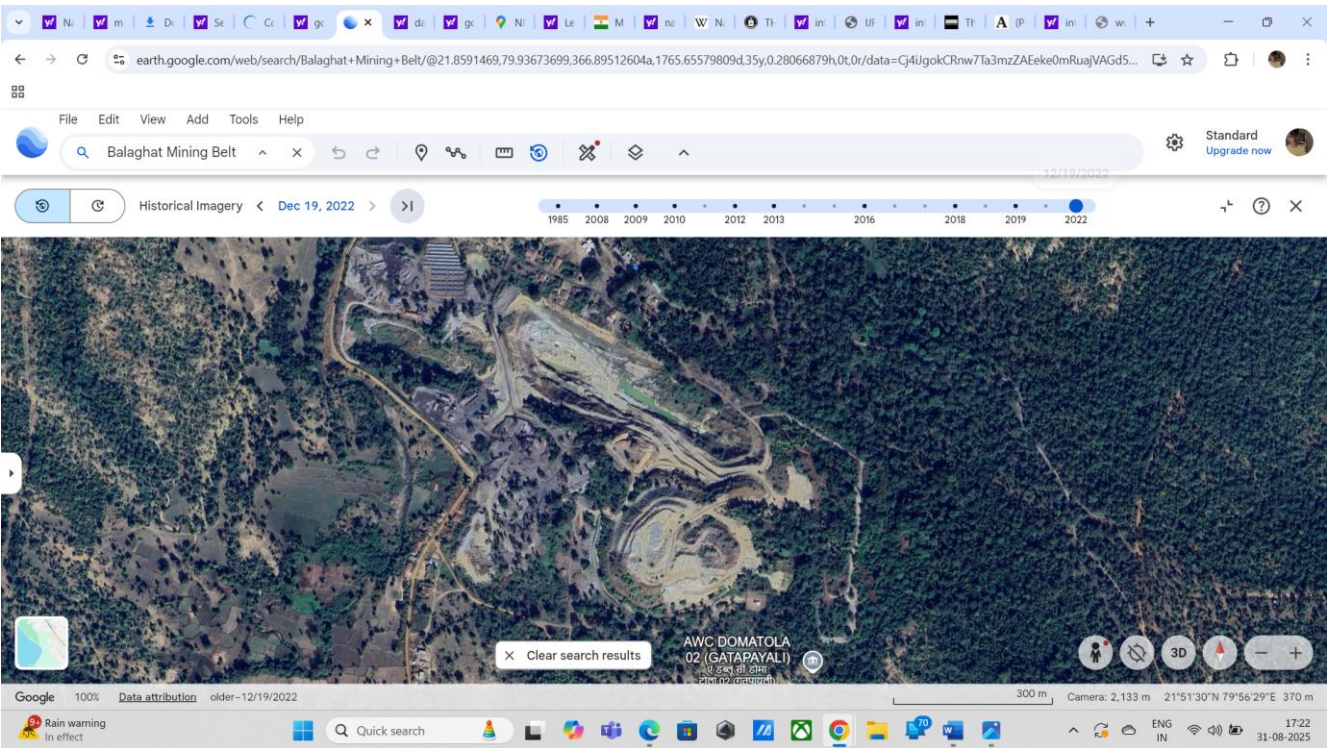
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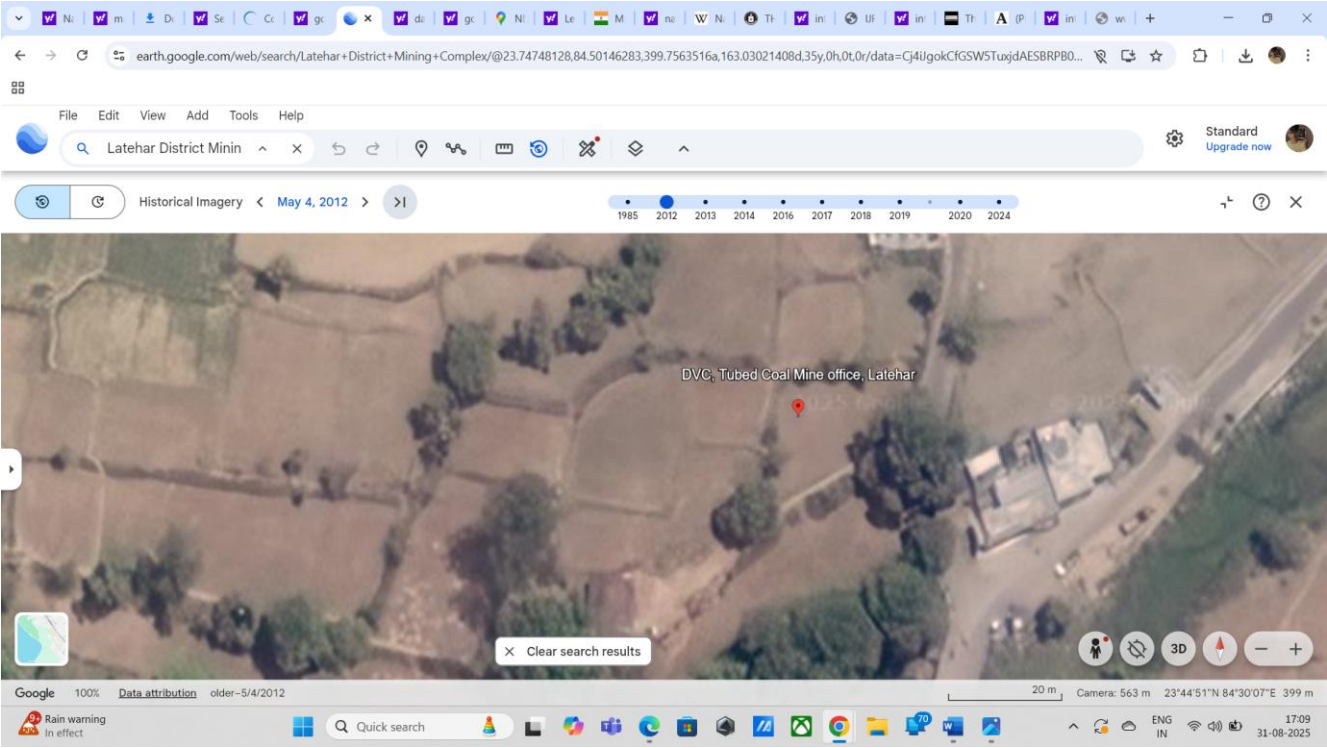
Before:



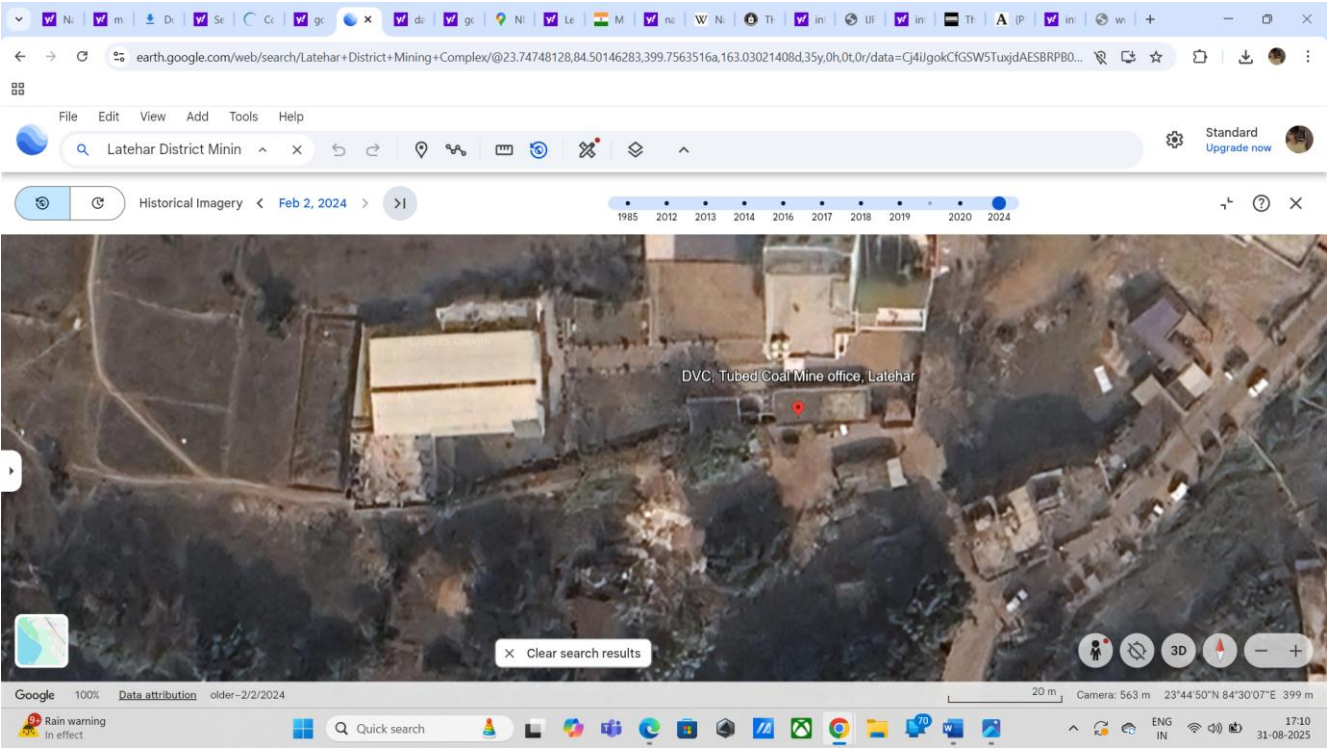
After:



Before:

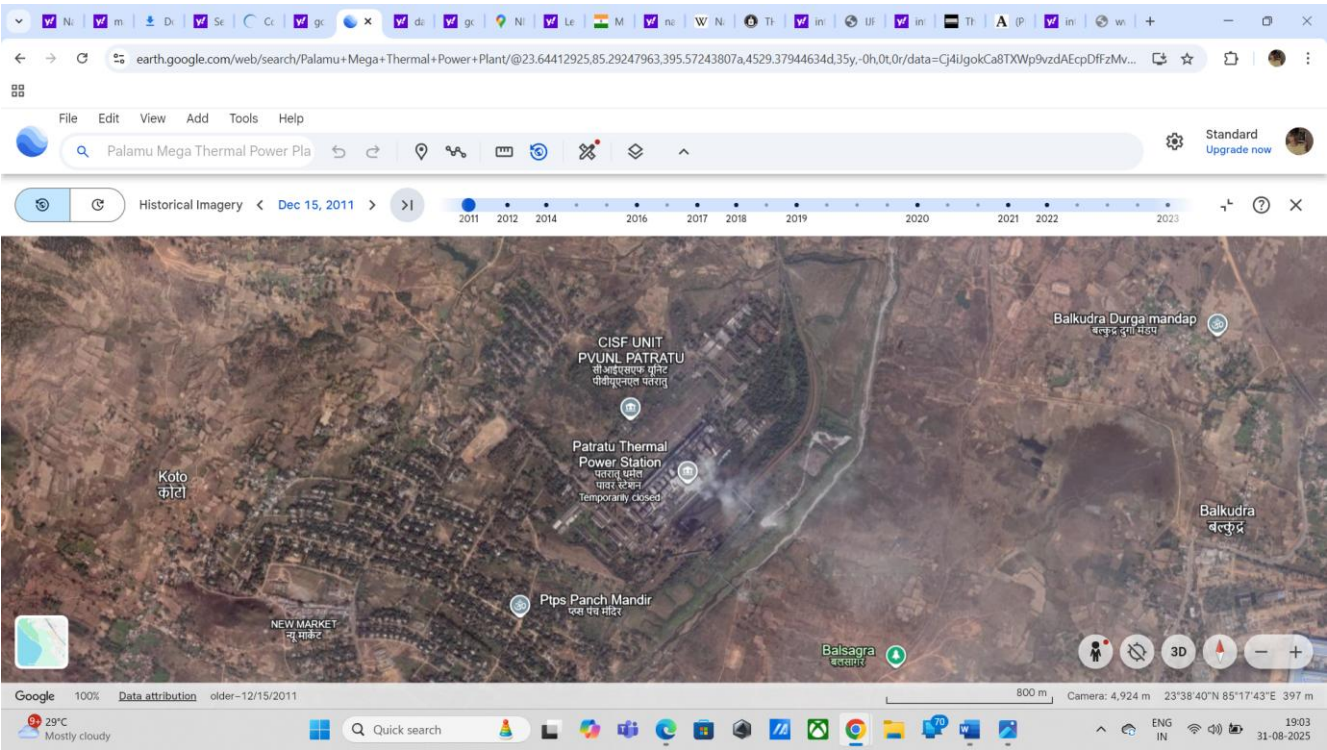


After:

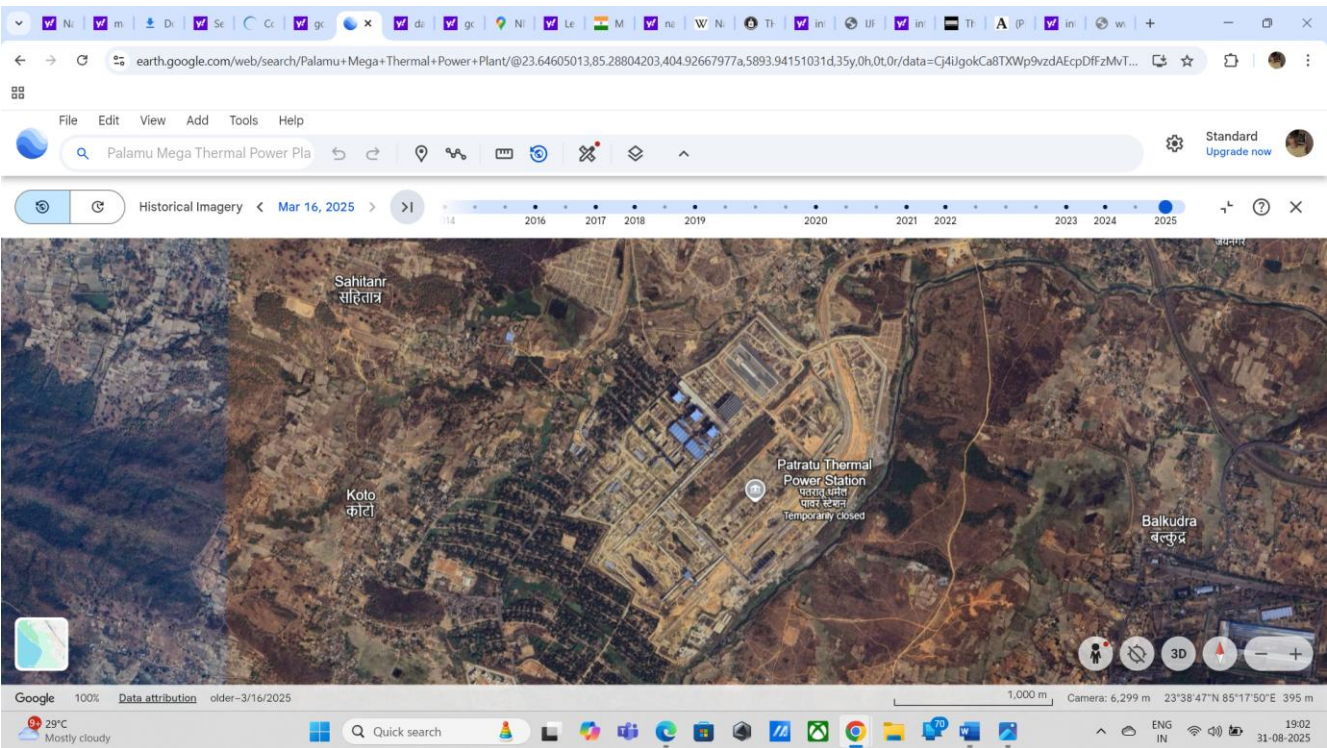


Palamu Mega Thermal Power Plant (Near Medininagar), Jharkhand

Before:

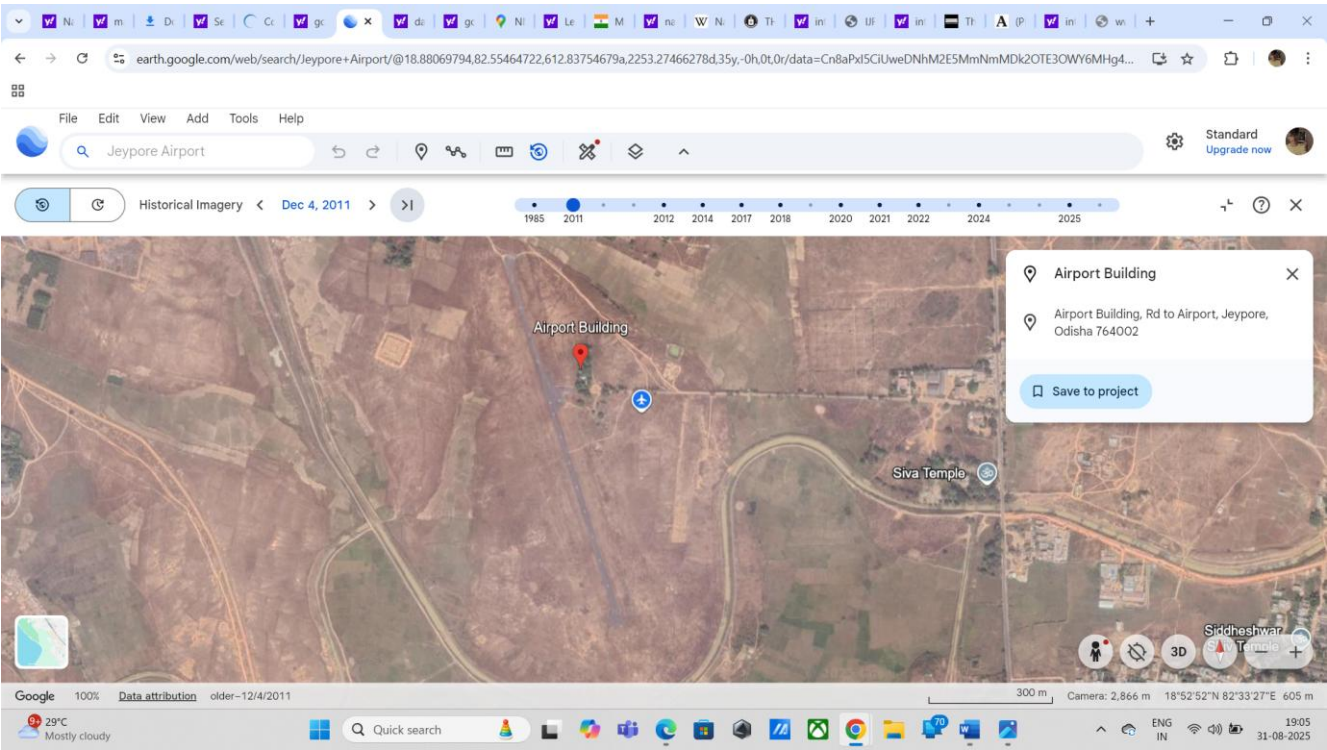


After:

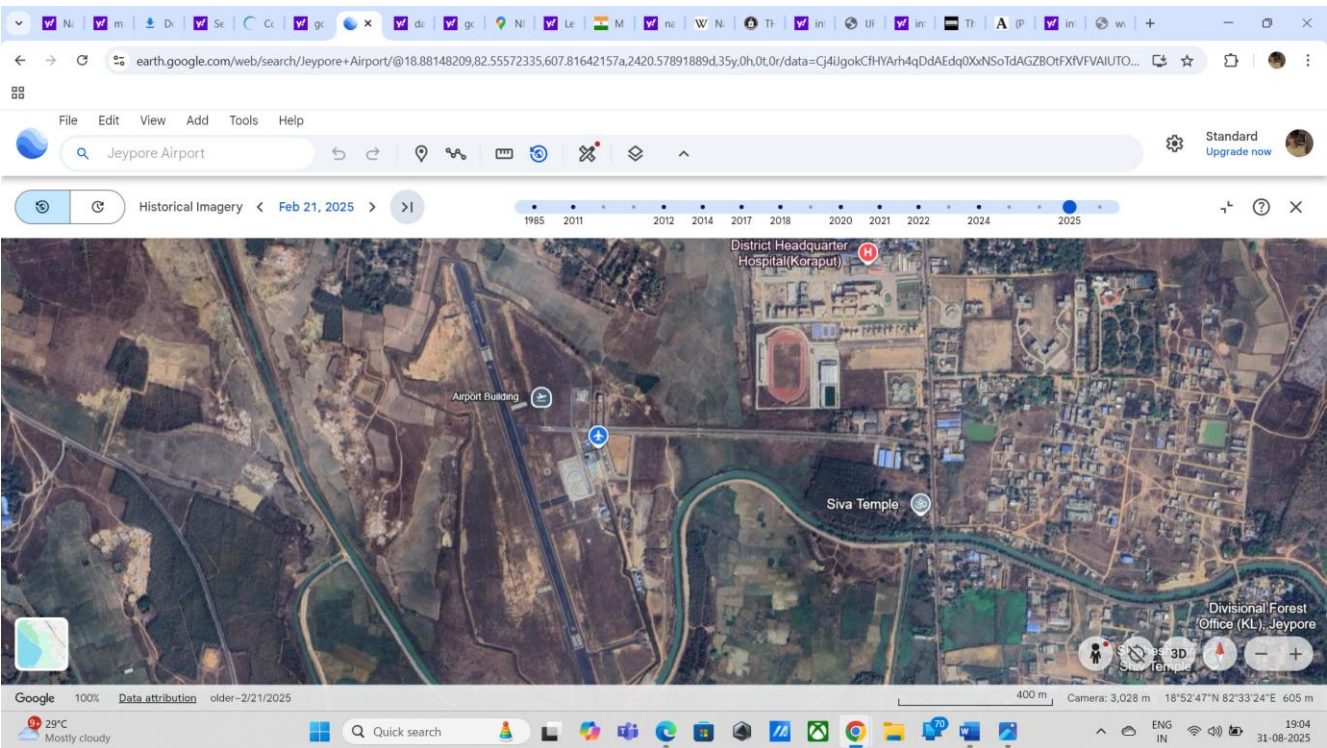


Jeypore Airport , Odisha(Koraput District, LWE-hit area)

Before:



After:



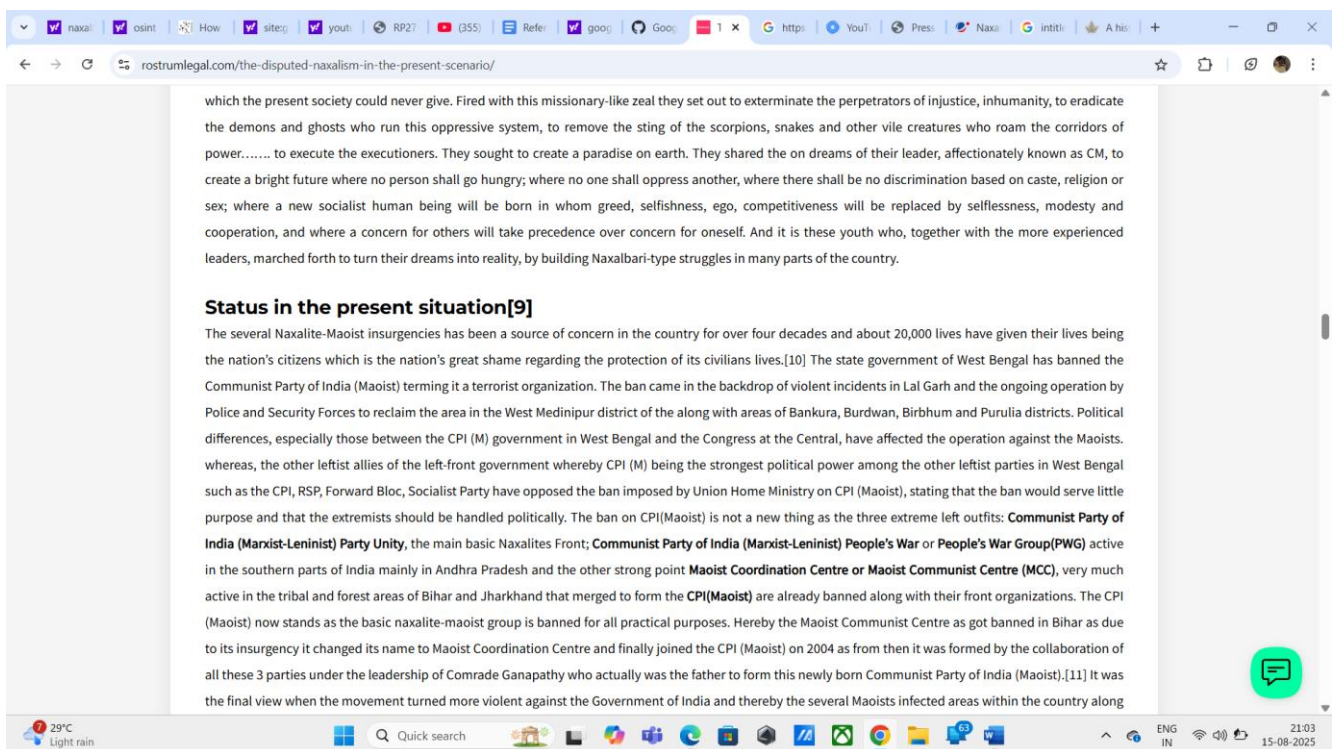
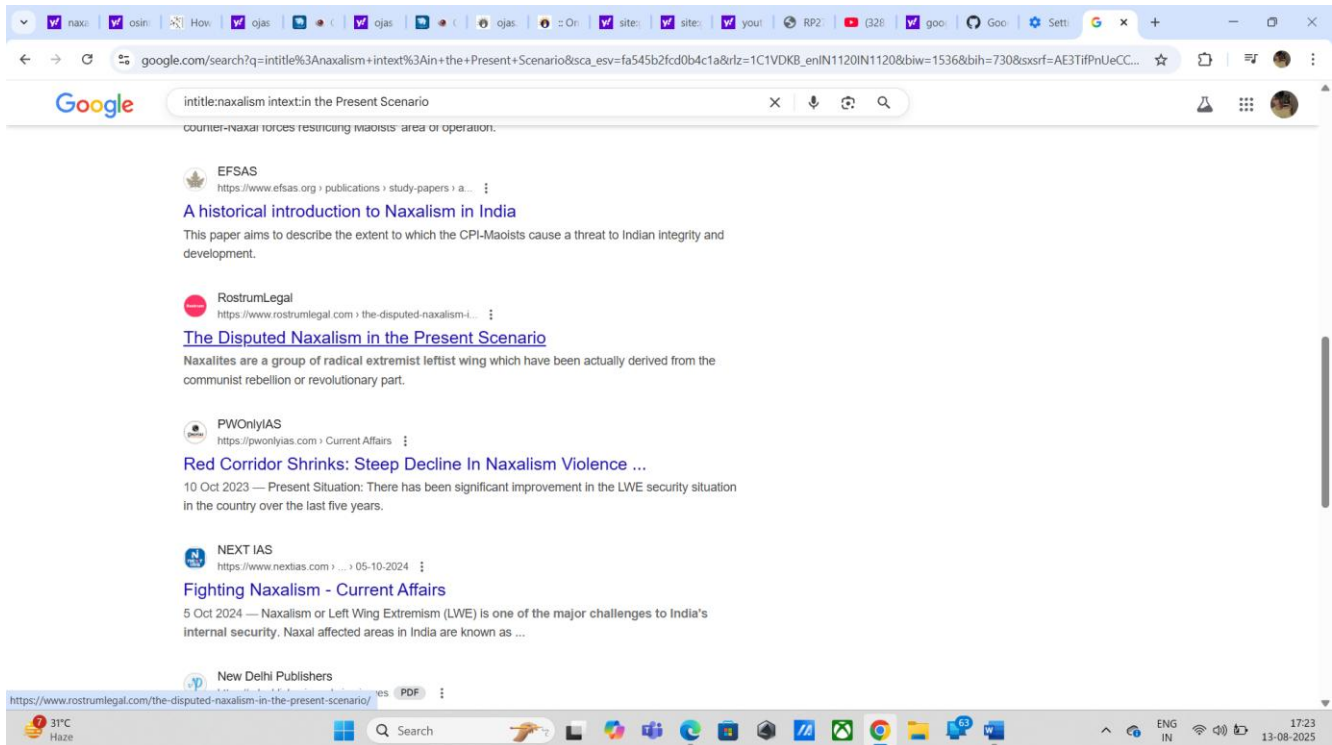
3. Current Scanerio of Naxalism in India:



3.1 Overview

In recent years, the Naxalite-Maoist insurgency has witnessed a marked decline in both strength and territorial spread. Once stretching across nearly 96 districts in the so-called “Red Corridor,” Maoist influence is now confined to limited pockets of **Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, and Odisha**, with occasional incidents reported in Maharashtra, Telangana, and Andhra Pradesh. Official figures show a steady reduction in incidents, casualties, and the number of affected districts, reflecting the impact of the Government of India’s multi-pronged strategy combining security operations, development initiatives, and community outreach. While the movement is considerably weakened, intelligence inputs and sporadic high-impact attacks demonstrate that the insurgency is not yet fully eradicated, and vigilance remains essential until the government’s stated goal of eliminating Left Wing Extremism by **March 2026** is achieved.

- I used the Google Dork query:
intitle:naxalism intext:"in the Present Scenario"
to find resources specifically discussing the current situation of Naxalism in India.



The Naxalite–Maoist insurgency has remained one of India’s longest-running internal security challenges, claiming more than 20,000 civilian and security lives over the past four decades. This persistent violence represents not only a national security issue but also a moral and political failure in safeguarding the lives of ordinary citizens.

The ban of CPI , however, was not unprecedented. Earlier, three of the most militant Maoist outfits—the CPI (Marxist–Leninist) Party Unity, the People’s War Group (PWG), and the Maoist Coordination Centre (MCC)—had all been proscribed for their involvement in armed insurgency. These groups later merged in 2004 to form the CPI (Maoist), under the leadership of Muppala Lakshmana Rao (Ganapathy). This unification intensified the conflict, leading to heightened violence, mass displacements, and rising civilian casualties. Between 2008 and 2010 alone, deaths due to Maoist-related incidents rose sharply from 638 to 1,174.

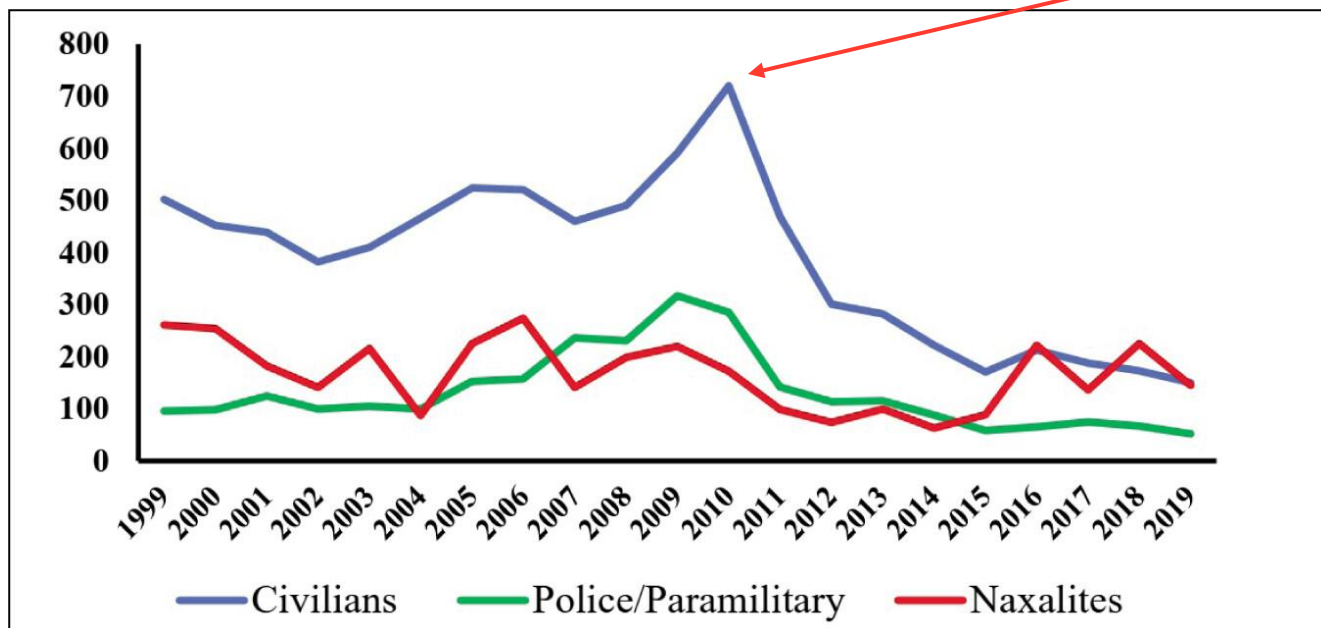


The ideological fragmentation of the Naxalite movement also shaped its trajectory. During the 1980s, divisions emerged between groups favoring armed struggle and those seeking parliamentary engagement. The CPI (ML) Liberation, through its political front—the Indian People’s Front (IPF)—shifted towards electoral politics, contesting and even winning parliamentary seats, notably in Ara (Bihar) during the 1989 Lok Sabha elections. By contrast, the PWG remained

firmly committed to armed revolution, rejecting parliamentary democracy as a bourgeois system. The Liberation’s moderate stance, however, never fully abandoned the possibility of armed revolution, as its party documents continued to stress the need for a people’s army and mass militancy to achieve decisive power.

This ideological split deepened in the post-Emergency years, as leaders released from prison pursued different paths. By 2003, internal debates culminated in attempts to rearticulate the Maoist strategy through key documents on Marxism-Leninism-Maoism, party programs, and military tactics, underlining the persistence of armed struggle as central to the movement.

The intensity of Maoist violence was evident in the late 2000s. In 2010, India recorded 1,180 casualties linked to the insurgency, surpassing fatalities from all other insurgent movements in the country combined. Maoists styled themselves as the defenders of marginalized peasants and tribal communities, portraying the insurgency as a legitimate freedom struggle against state repression, feudal oppression, and exploitative development models. Their influence was particularly strong in West Bengal, Bihar, Jharkhand, Odisha, and Chhattisgarh, where they built parallel governance structures and held sway over large forested and tribal regions.

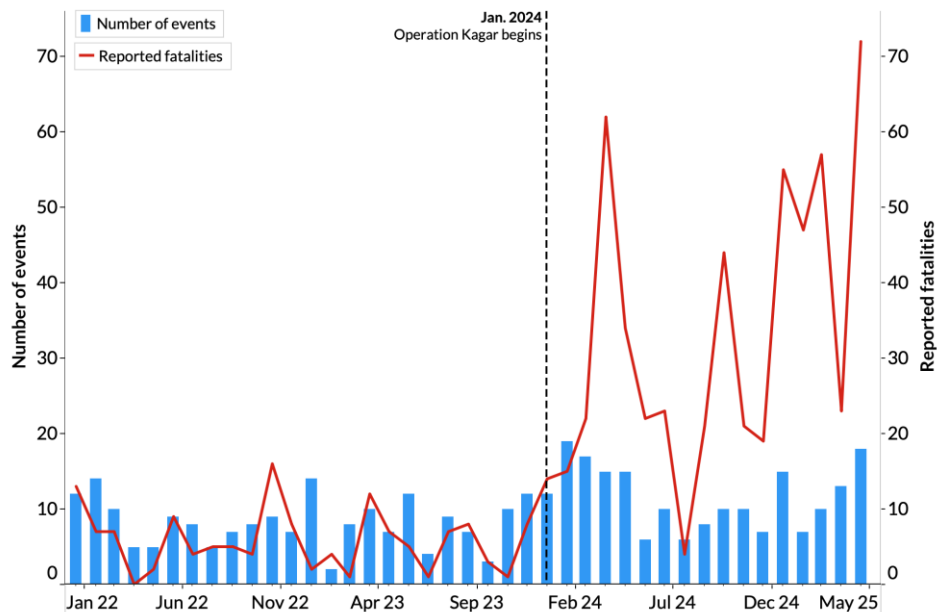


Notably, in June 2009, around 300–400 armed Maoist guerrillas stormed Lalgarh, seizing control of the town, including its police station, and effectively dismantling symbols of state authority. They attacked critical infrastructure—blowing up a railway building, destroying mobile towers Koraput (Odisha), and cutting off more than 100 villages. Similar uprisings and sabotage operations were reported across Karnataka, West Bengal, and Bihar, where Maoists ambushed police convoys, freed imprisoned comrades, and targeted state assets like mobile towers and cultural centers.

The Indian state responded with large-scale counterinsurgency measures. Security forces, including the Border Security Force (BSF) and Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF), launched operations involving thousands of personnel. While they claimed tactical successes, independent observers noted that Maoists continued to maintain dominance in nearly 90% of some districts, such as Lalgarh, highlighting the limits of military-only solutions.

Armed clashes involving Naxal-Maoist rebels in the Red Corridor

January 2022 - May 2025



The chart highlights a fluctuating but overall intense pattern of Maoist-related violence in recent years. While the number of incidents remained relatively stable in 2022–2023, a sharp escalation is visible in 2024 with both clashes and fatalities rising significantly. This surge corresponds to intensified counter-insurgency operations, particularly Operation Kagar, where security forces targeted Maoist strongholds in Chhattisgarh’s Abujmahar region.

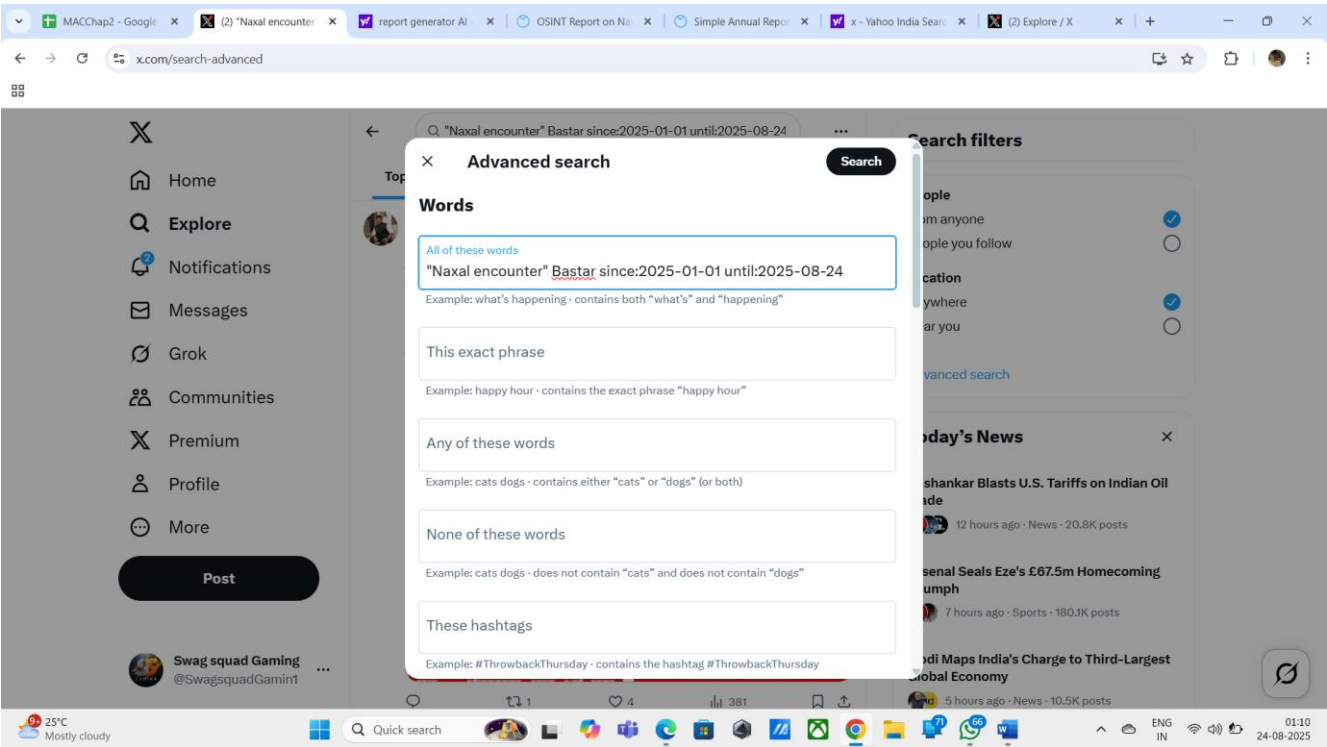
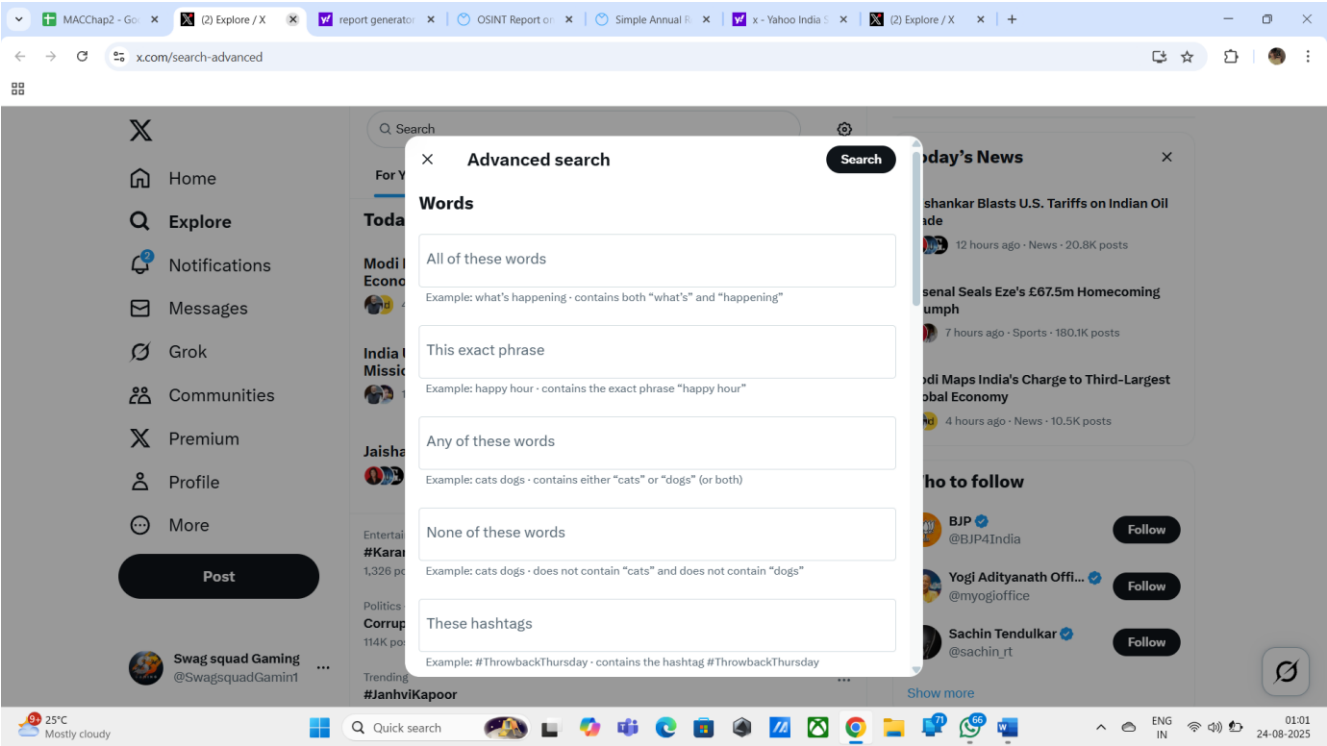
By early 2025, fatalities had already surpassed the total recorded in 2024, underscoring both the continued strength of Maoist networks in core areas and the effectiveness of security pushback that resulted in large cadre losses. The data validates the government’s claim of a shrinking insurgency footprint while also demonstrating that the movement, though weakened, is capable of periodic violent escalations.

This evidence, derived through OSINT methods (ACLED conflict datasets cross-referenced with PIB statistics), visually shows how the Maoist insurgency has transitioned from a widespread threat to a concentrated but still dangerous presence in a handful of districts.

This phase of the insurgency underscored both the resilience of the Maoist movement and the heavy costs of conflict. The ideological rigidity of hardline factions like the PWG, combined with widespread disillusionment among rural and tribal populations, sustained their support base. Meanwhile, the Indian state struggled to balance between political negotiations, development interventions, and heavy-handed military campaigns. As a result, the Naxalite–Maoist insurgency became not just a security challenge, but a symbol of India’s deeper structural inequalities—landlessness, tribal alienation, and lack of inclusive governance—without which any attempt at permanent resolution appeared fragile.

3.2 SOCMINT (Social Media Intelligence):

I have used Advance search tool of X formally known as twitter to see current trends of nakshalwad in india:



MACChap2 - Google x (2) Naxal OR Maoist x report generator AI x OSINT Report on Nax x Simple Annual Repor x x - Yahoo India Sear x (2) Explore / X x + - x

x.com/search-advanced

Advanced search

Words

All of these words
Naxal OR Maoist OR "Operation Kagar" OR "weapon seizure" OR "cad"
Example: what's happening - contains both "what's" and "happening"

This exact phrase
Naxal encounter
Example: happy hour - contains the exact phrase "happy hour"

Any of these words
Naxalism, nakshalwad, CPI(Maoist), insurgency, surrender
Example: cats dogs - contains either "cats" or "dogs" (or both)

None of these words
festival, movie, cricket, Bollywood
Example: cats dogs - does not contain "cats" and does not contain "dogs"

These hashtags
#NaxalEncounter #Bastar #OperationKagar
Example: #ThrowbackThursday - contains the hashtag #ThrowbackThursday

Search filters

Today's News

Jaishankar Blasts U.S. Tariffs on Indian Oil Trade

Arsenal Seals Eze's £67.5m Homecoming Triumph

Modi Maps India's Charge to Third-Largest Global Economy

25°C Mostly cloudy

Quick search

ENG IN

01:08 24-08-2025

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x.com/search?q="Naxal%20encounter"%20Bastar%20since%3A2025-01-01%20until%3A2025-08-24&src=typed_query

Search filters

People

From anyone

People you follow

Location

Anywhere

Near you

Advanced search

Today's News

Jaishankar Blasts U.S. Tariffs on Indian Oil Trade

Arsenal Seals Eze's £67.5m Homecoming Triumph

Modi Maps India's Charge to Third-Largest Global Economy

Top Latest People Media Lists

Labhesh Ghosh (Bhilai Times) @labheshghosh · Jun 12
#Chhattisgarh में ASP की शहदत के बाद सुरक्षाबलों का जवाब।
सुकमा में 2 हार्डकोर माओवादी डेर
एक महिला, एक पुरुष
INSAS राइफल, भरमार हथियार व विस्फोटक बरामद
जल्द नक्सल मुक्त होगा बस्तर
@truth_finder04 @yashwantbhilai @bhilaitimes
#Sukma #Naxal #Encounter #SecurityForces #Bastar

मुचाकी बामन उर्फ कूटा

अनिता अदलम

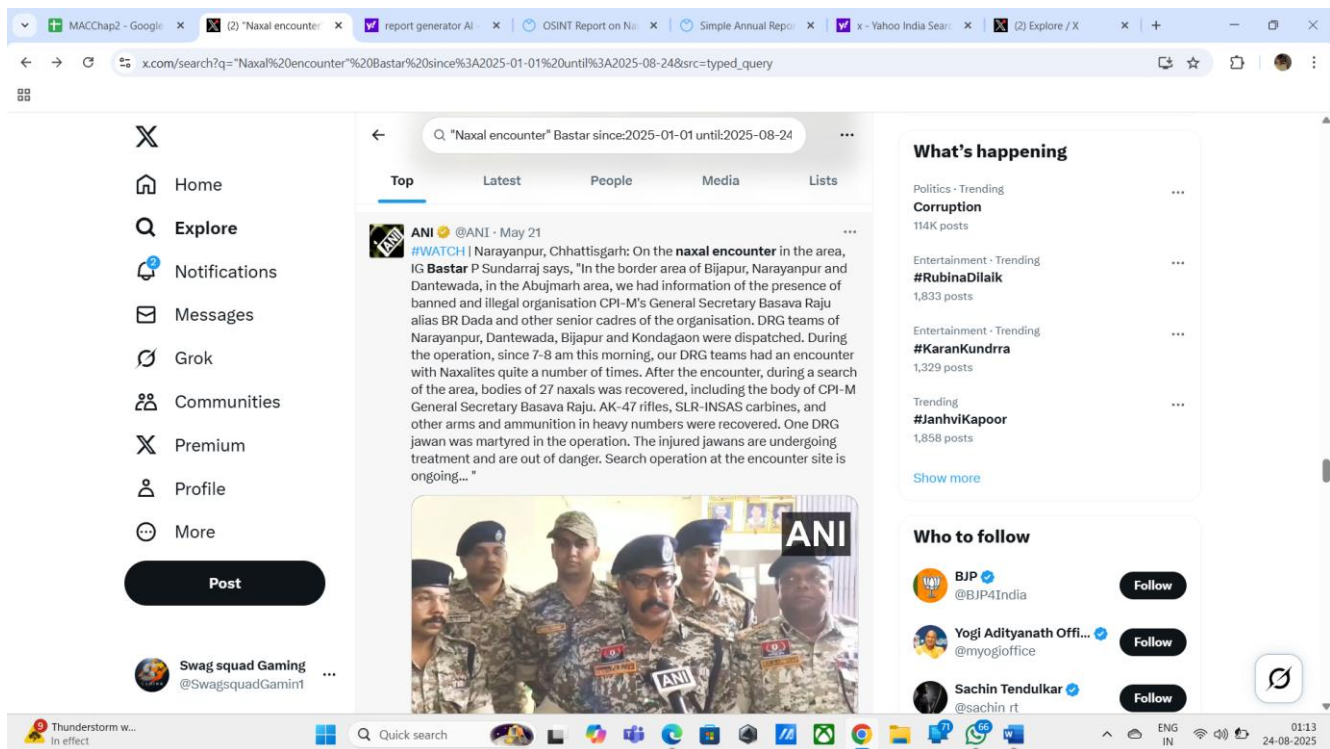
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Rain warning In effect

Quick search

ENG IN

01:13 24-08-2025



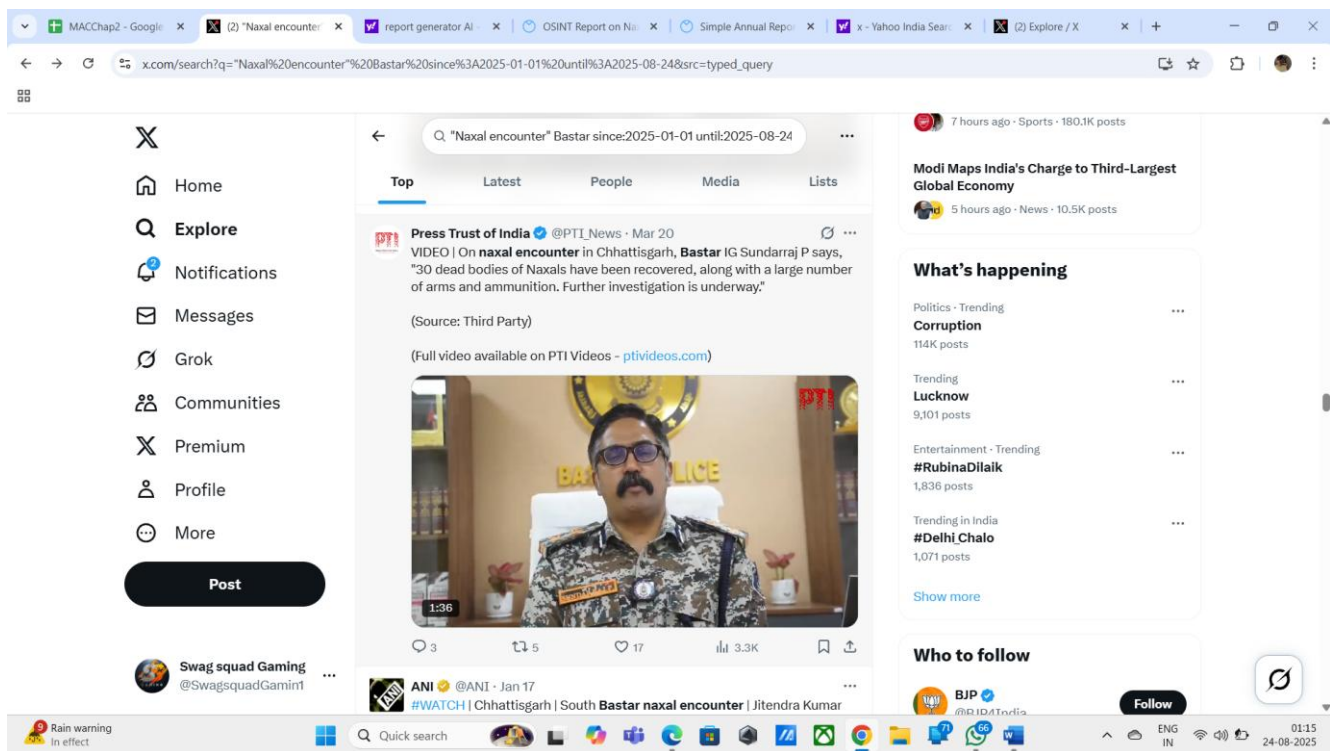
Event: Naxal Encounter in Narayanpur, Chhattisgarh

Date/Time: May 21, 2025

Source: X/Twitter ANI(IG Bastar P. Sundarraj statement)

Summary: DRG teams from Narayanpur, Dantewada, Bijapur, and Kondagaon conducted an operation in Abujmarh. The operation resulted in 27 Naxal fatalities, including CPI-M General Secretary Basava Raju. Several firearms were recovered. One DRG jawan was killed; injured personnel are stable. Search operations are ongoing.

- **OSINT Angle:** Twitter posts from ANI/PTI first reported the event. PIB press release later confirmed casualty figures. Local journalists on X provided images of recovered weapons.
- **Significance:** First time a serving CPI (M) General Secretary was killed in combat; marked a historic setback for Maoist leadership.



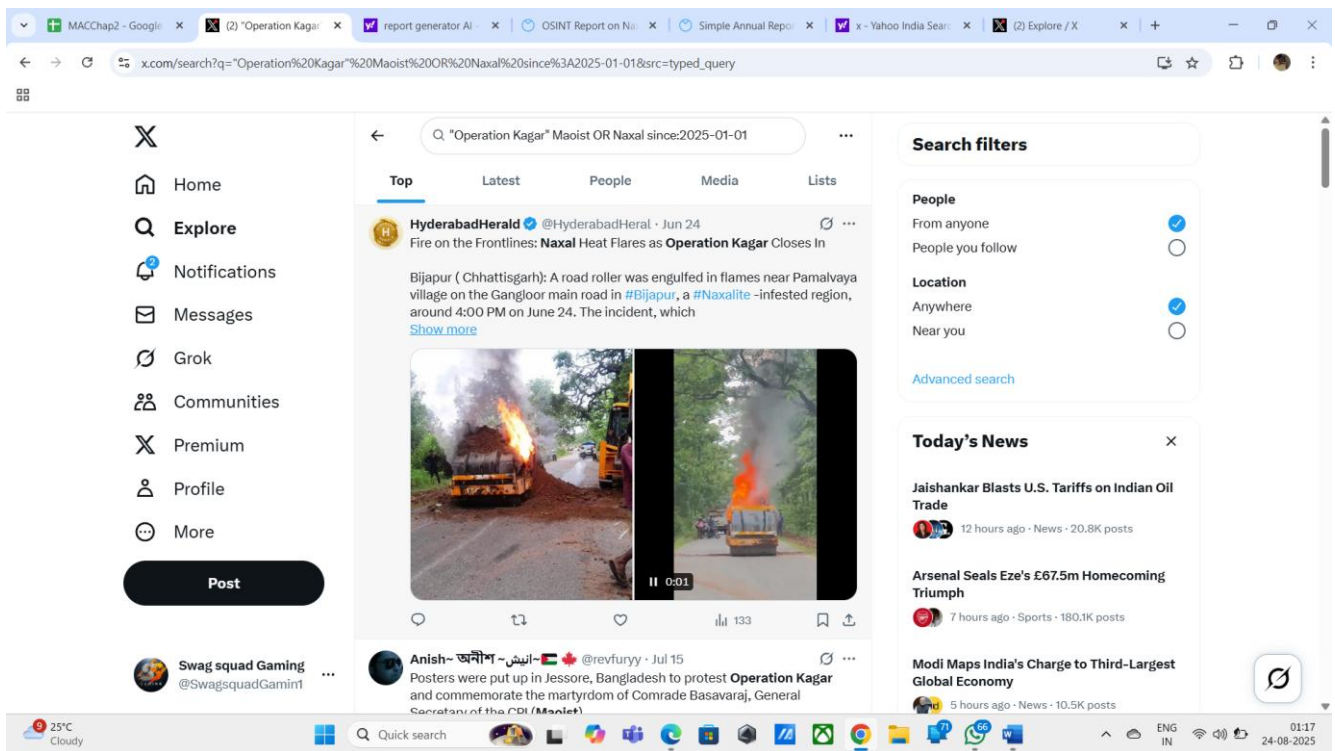
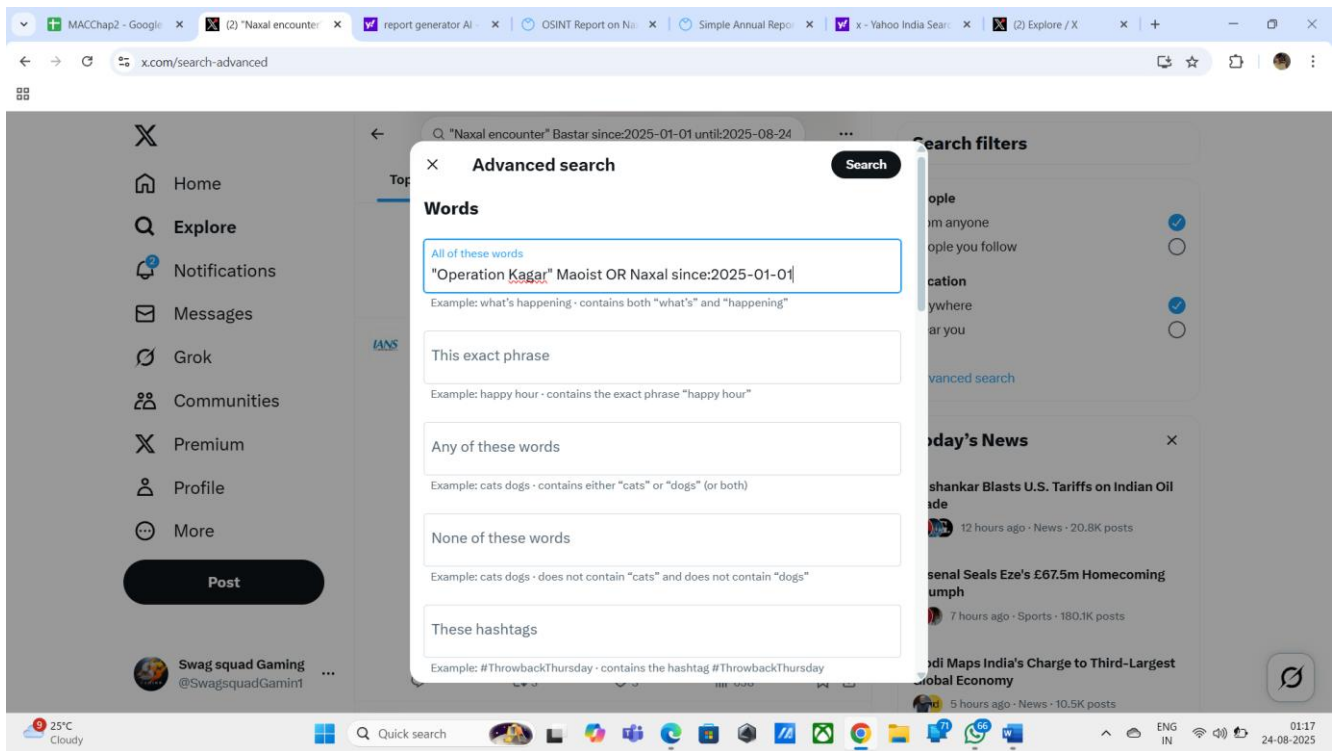
Event: Naxal Encounter in Bastar, Chhattisgarh

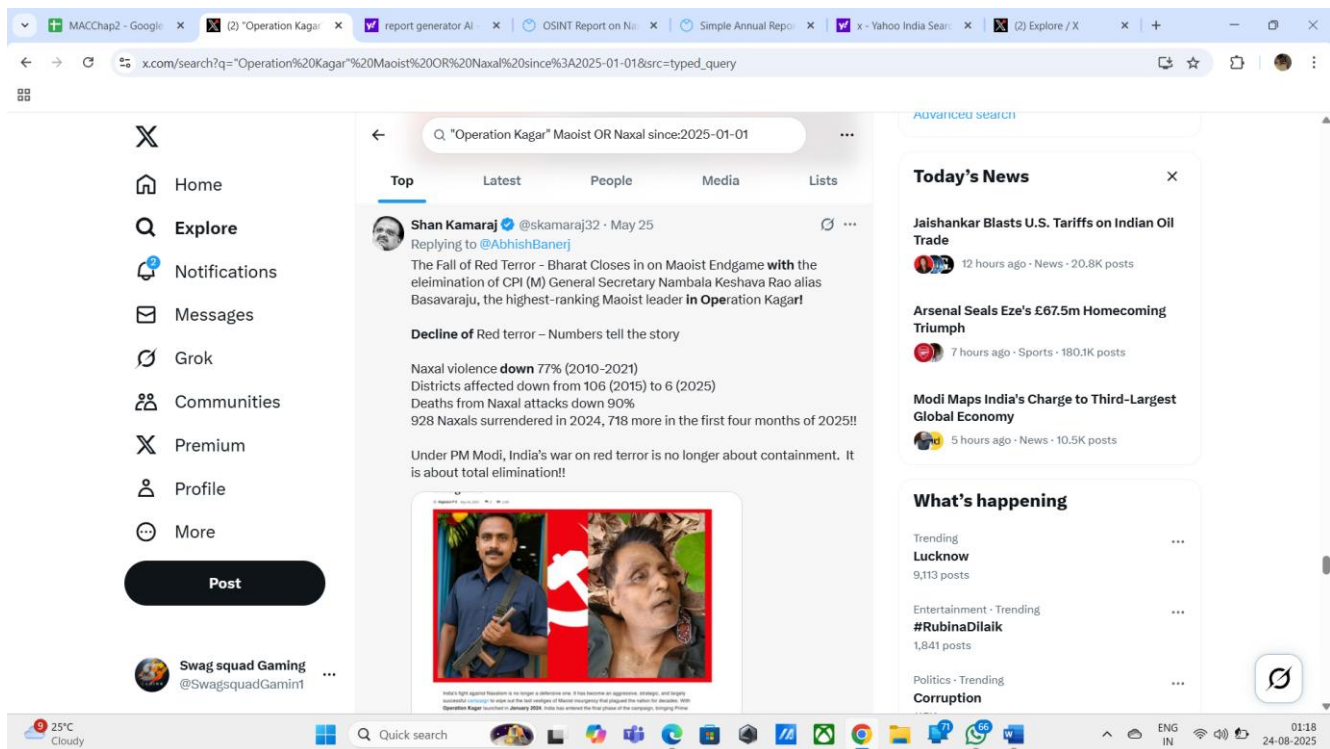
Date/Time: March 20, 2025

Source: X/Twitter – Press Trust of India (@PTI_News)

Summary:

During a Naxal encounter in Chhattisgarh's Bastar region, IG Sundarraaj P. stated that 30 Naxal bodies were recovered along with a significant cache of arms and ammunition. Further investigation is ongoing.





Event: Elimination of CPI (M) General Secretary Nambala Keshava Rao (Basavaraju)

Date/Time: May, 2025

Source: X/Twitter – Retweets

Summary:

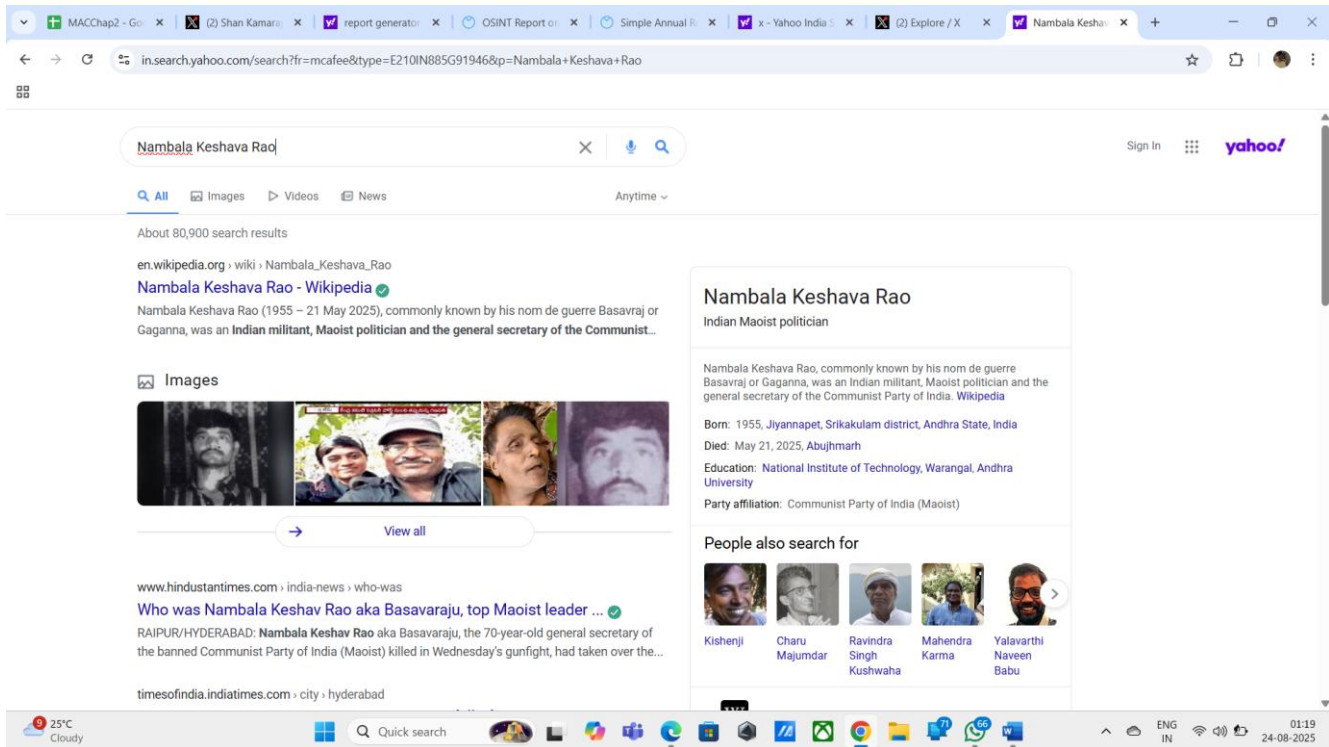
In a major development in India's counter-Maoist operations, CPI (M) General Secretary Nambala Keshava Rao, alias Basavaraju, the highest-ranking Maoist leader, was eliminated during Operation Kagar. Naxal violence has significantly declined: incidents dropped 77% between 2010 and 2021, affected districts fell from 106 in 2015 to 6 in 2025, and deaths from attacks decreased by 90%.

Additionally, 928 Naxals surrendered in 2024, with 718 more in the first four months of 2025.

Officials highlighted that under PM Modi, India's approach to red terror has shifted from containment to total elimination.

3.3 POI OSINT:

- Nambala Keshava Rao



Nambala Keshava Rao (1955 – 21 May 2025), better known by his underground names Basavraj or Gaganna, was one of the most prominent figures in India's Maoist insurgency. A long-time member of the Communist Party of India (Maoist), he eventually rose to become its General Secretary and military strategist. For decades, he remained on the radar of Indian security agencies and was listed among the country's most wanted fugitives.

Rao was killed on 21 May 2025 in a major gun battle with government forces in Abujmahar, Chhattisgarh, alongside 27 other Naxals. His death marked a historic moment — the first time a serving General Secretary of the CPI (Maoist) had been neutralized in direct combat with security forces.

Early Life and Education

Rao was born in Jiyannapet village, Srikakulam district, Andhra Pradesh, to a teacher, Vasudeva Rao, and a homemaker, Narayanamma. An academically bright student, he completed his B.Tech. from the Regional Engineering College, Warangal (now NIT Warangal).

During his student years, he was active in left-wing politics and became involved with the Radical Students Union (RSU). His activism and leadership skills soon placed him at the forefront of student movements. Despite being arrested once in 1980 following a clash with RSS-affiliated student groups,

he continued down the path of radical politics. By the late 1970s, he had left his village behind, never owning property in his name.

Rise in Maoist Politics

Rao's involvement in the Naxalite movement began in the **1970s**. He became one of the early organizers when the **CPI (ML) People's War** was founded in 1980. His reputation grew as a commander skilled in guerrilla tactics.

By the late 1980s, he had trained in the forests of Bastar under former fighters of Sri Lanka's **LTTE**, learning ambush strategies and handling explosives. Over time, he became known for his expertise with improvised explosive devices (IEDs), which became a hallmark of Maoist attacks.

In **1992**, he was inducted into the Central Committee of the People's War group. After the merger of the People's War and the Maoist Communist Centre in **2004**, Rao was appointed head of the party's **Central Military Commission**, solidifying his role as the key military brain behind the CPI (Maoist).

When long-time leader Ganapathy resigned in **2018**, Rao stepped in as **General Secretary**, the highest position in the organization. The **National Investigation Agency (NIA)** had announced a **₹10 lakh reward** for his capture.

Major Attacks Linked to Him

Security officials attribute several of the most high-profile Maoist attacks to Rao's leadership:

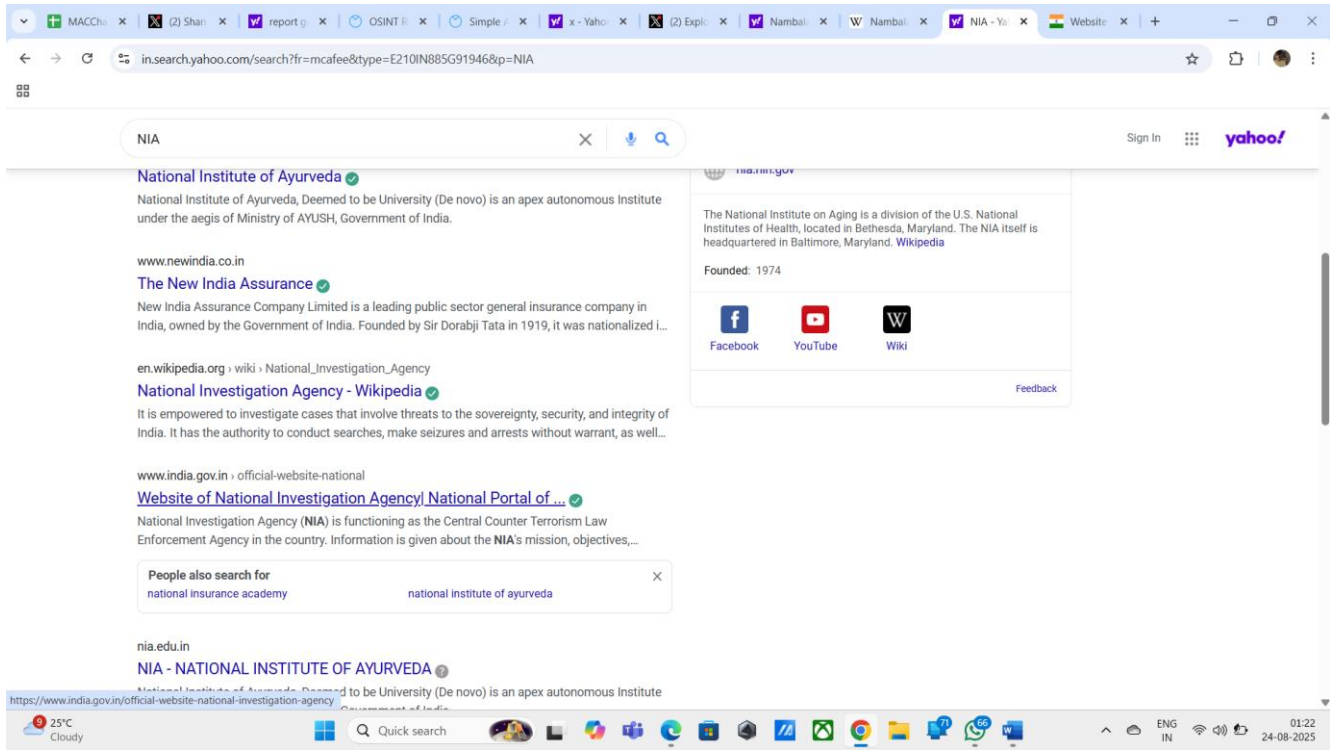
- **2010 Dantewada Attack** – 76 CRPF personnel killed.
- **2013 Latehar Ambush (Jharkhand)** – Use of a photosensitive IED concealed in a slain soldier's body.
- **2013 Jeeram Ghati Attack (Chhattisgarh)** – 27 killed, including senior Congress leaders.
- **2018 Sukma IED Attack** – 9 CRPF personnel killed.
- **2019 Gadchiroli Landmine Blast (Maharashtra)** – 15 police personnel and a driver killed.
- **2021 Sukma-Bijapur Ambush (Chhattisgarh)** – 22 security personnel killed.
- **2023 Dantewada IED Blast** – 10 District Reserve Guard (DRG) personnel and a civilian driver killed.
- **2025 Bijapur IED Attack** – 8 DRG personnel and a civilian driver killed.

Each of these incidents demonstrated his tactical approach: heavy reliance on IEDs, surprise ambushes, and targeting of both political figures and security forces.

Death and Reactions

On 21 May 2025, Rao and his group were surrounded in the forests of Abujhmarh. The gunfight ended with the death of 28 Maoists, including Rao himself. His elimination was seen as a critical blow to the Maoist insurgency.

Left-wing parties such as the CPI, CPI(M), and CPI(ML) Liberation condemned the operation, accusing the central government of closing doors on dialogue and choosing military suppression instead.



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nia.gov.in

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National Investigation Agency
Government of India
राष्ट्रीय अन्वेषण अभिकरण
भारत सरकार

Nambala Keshava Rao English
Nambala Keshav Rao

2025
International Year of Cooperatives
सन्तुलन जयते

75
आज़ादी का
अमृत महोत्सव

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nia.gov.in/wanted-details.htm?575

राष्ट्रीय अन्वेषण अभिकरण
भारत सरकार

International Year of Cooperatives
सन्तुलन जयते

WANTED DETAILS
Home > Most Wanted > Wanted Details

 Nambala Keshav Rao

Aliases : Nambala Keshava Rao @ Gaganna @ Basavraj @ Prakash @ Krishna @ Vijay @ Keshav @ Raju @ Umesh

Parentage : S/o Late N. Vasudeva Rao

Address : R/o Village- Jiyannapeta, PS & Mandalam- Kotabommali, Distt- Srikakulam, Andhra Pradesh

Accused Status : Absconding

Age/DOB (Approx) : 65 years

For any information, please Contact

E-mail : assistance.nia@gov.in

Phone No. : 011-24368800

Postal Address : National Investigation Agency, Opp CGO Complex, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110003

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Profile of Key Naxalite Leaders (OSINT Reference)

Case Example: Nambala Keshav Rao (“Basavaraj”)

- **Aliases:** Gaganna, Basavaraj, Prakash, Krishna, Vijay, Keshav, Raju, Umesh
- **Parentage:** Son of Late N. Vasudeva Rao
- **Origin:** Native of Jiyannapeta Village, Kotabommali Mandal, Srikakulam District, Andhra Pradesh
- **Approximate Age:** 65 years
- **Accused Status:** *Absconding* (as per the National Investigation Agency – NIA, India)
- **Designation/Role:** Considered to be the **General Secretary of CPI (Maoist)** and one of the top ideologues of the movement.
- **OSINT Source:** Extracted from **NIA Most Wanted Portal** (Official Government of India website).

This OSINT reference demonstrates how open and government-published data can be used to track profiles of high-ranking individuals in the Naxal insurgency. Including such information strengthens the credibility of intelligence-based reporting.

OSINT Tracking of Nambala Keshav Rao

While exploring open sources, I started by running an advanced Twitter search with keywords like “Nambala Keshav Rao”, “Basavaraj CPI Maoist” and his aliases (*Gaganna, Prakash, Krishna*). Using Twitter’s filter options (date, language, exact phrase), I was able to identify discussions by journalists and security analysts that mentioned him in connection with recent Maoist activities.

From there, I cross-referenced his identity through Wikipedia, where an updated profile of Nambala Keshav Rao is available. The page outlined his background, leadership role as the General Secretary of CPI (Maoist), and his involvement in the Naxalite movement.

Finally, I validated this information with an authoritative government source, the NIA Most Wanted Portal, which confirmed his aliases, origin, absconding status, and approximate age.

This layered approach — *Twitter (real-time chatter)* → *Wikipedia (background info)* → *NIA Portal (official validation)* — demonstrates how OSINT techniques can build a comprehensive profile of a person of interest.

3.4 Affected Corridors:

in.search.yahoo.com/search?fr=mcafee&type=E210IN885G91946&p=site%3A.gov.in+naxalism+affected+districts+2005+filetype%3Apdf

site:.gov.in naxalism affected districts 2005 filetype:pdf

About 575 search results

www.mha.gov.in › sites › default
Annual Report - Ministry of Home Affairs ✓
However, the problem has affected a larger area in varying degrees. At present, 76 districts in 9 States of Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Orissa,...

static.pib.gov.in › WriteReadData › specificdocs
Naxalmukt Bharat Abhiyan: From Red Zones to Growth Corridors ✓
Out of total Naxalism-affected districts, number of most affected districts has been reduced from 12 to 6, which include four districts from Chhattisgarh (Bijapur, Kanker, Narayanpur, and Sukma),...

www.mcrhdi.gov.in › 5th_mesfc2023 › week8
LEFT WING MOVEMENT-CHALLENGES AND INITIATIVES OF THE GOVER... ✓
India has been dealing with three variants of the Internal Security challenge for decades and each has its own complexities — a proxy war and terrorism in Kashmir, sub-national separatist...

www.mha.gov.in › sites › default
Annual Report - Ministry of Home Affairs ✓
At present, 76 districts in 9 States, badly affected by naxal violence, are covered under this scheme. This Scheme was comprehensively revised in February, 2005 so as to enhance the level of...

static.pib.gov.in › WriteReadData › specificdocs

static.pib.gov.in/WriteReadData/specificdocs/documents/2025/apr/doc2025410538201.pdf

doc2025410538201.pdf

2 / 7 85% +

CIVILIANS KILLED BY LWE

Year	Civilians Killed
2010	720
2014	222
2024	121

INCIDENTS OF ATTACK ON ECONOMIC INFRASTRUCTURE

Year	Incidents of Attack
2010	365
2014	100
2024	25

State-wise details of LWE perpetrated violence (number of deaths recorded) in the last 3 years are as given under:

State	2022	2023	2024
Andhra Pradesh	3	3	1
Bihar	11	4	2
Chhattisgarh	246	305	267
Jharkhand	96	129	69
Kerala	0	4	0
Madhya Pradesh	16	7	11
Maharashtra	16	19	10
Odisha	16	12	6
Telangana	9	3	8
West Bengal	0	0	0
TOTAL	413	485	374

OSINT Data Collection on Naxalite Incidents

To assess the geographical spread and intensity of Naxalism in India, I used Google Dorking techniques to extract official government data. By applying advanced search operators such as: `site:pib.gov.in Naxalism incidents 2022 2023 2024 filetype:pdf`

I was able to retrieve Press Information Bureau (PIB) reports containing verified figures of Naxalite incidents across Indian states. These reports provided yearly statistics for 2022, 2023, and 2024.

From the PIB source, the following data was compiled:

State	2022	2023	2024
Andhra Pradesh	3	3	1
Bihar	11	4	2
Chhattisgarh	246	305	267
Jharkhand	96	129	69
Kerala	0	4	0
Madhya Pradesh	16	7	11
Maharashtra	16	19	10
Odisha	16	12	6
Telangana	9	3	8
West Bengal	0	0	0
TOTAL	413	485	374

This data clearly illustrates how certain states, especially Chhattisgarh and Jharkhand, remain hotspots of Left-Wing Extremism, whereas states like Bihar and Kerala have seen major declines.

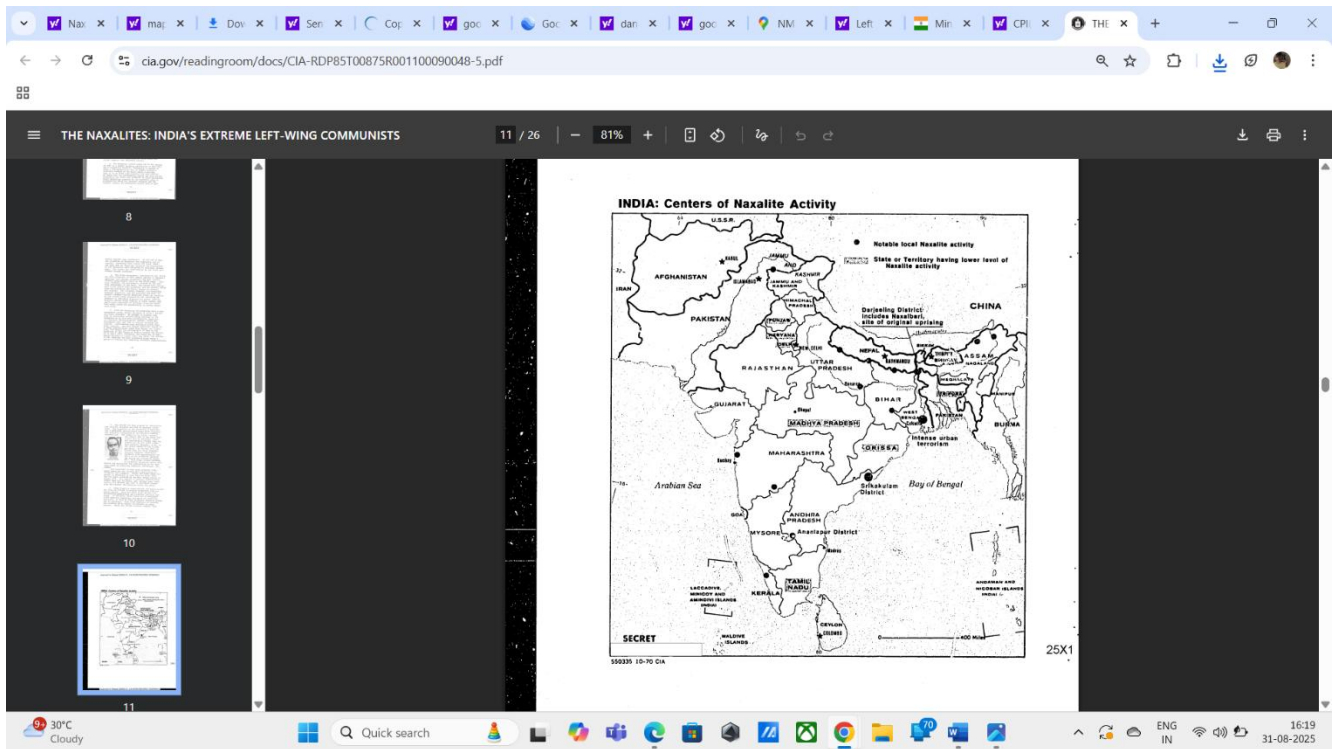
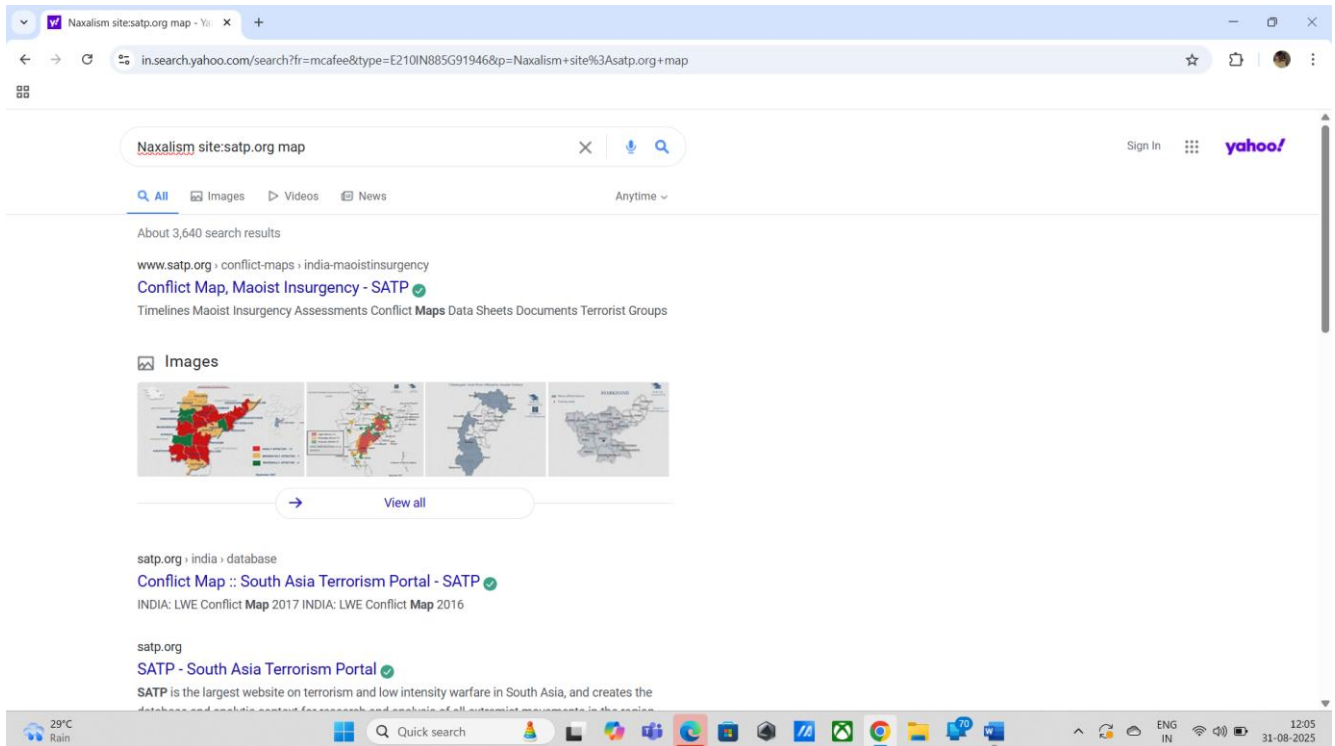
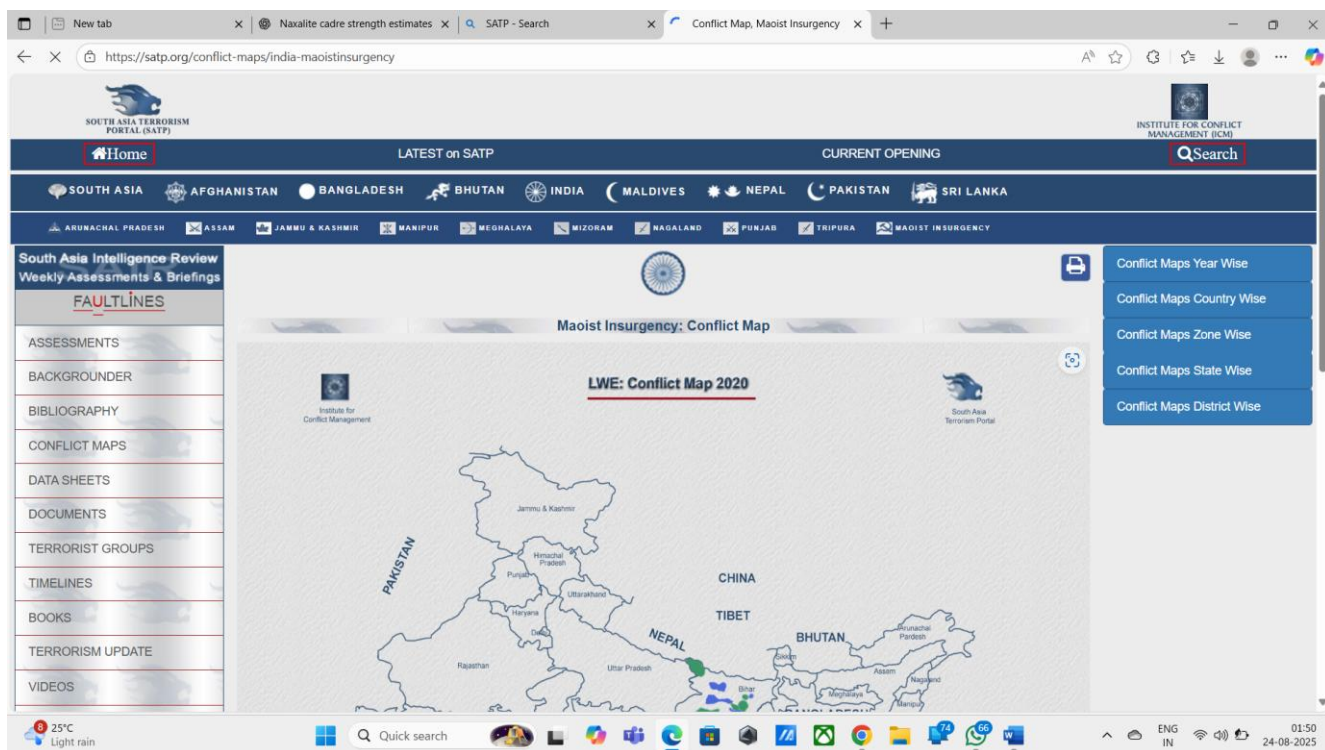
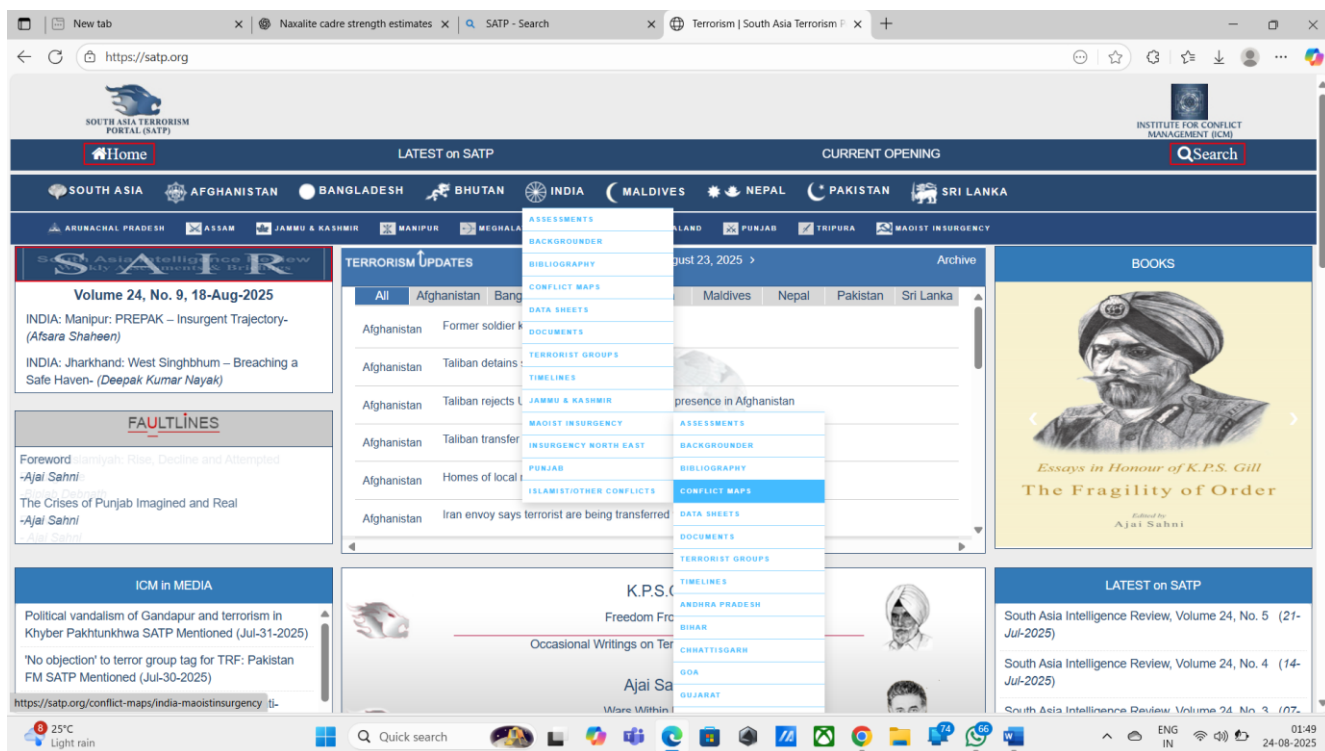


Figure 6: Centre of Naxalaim





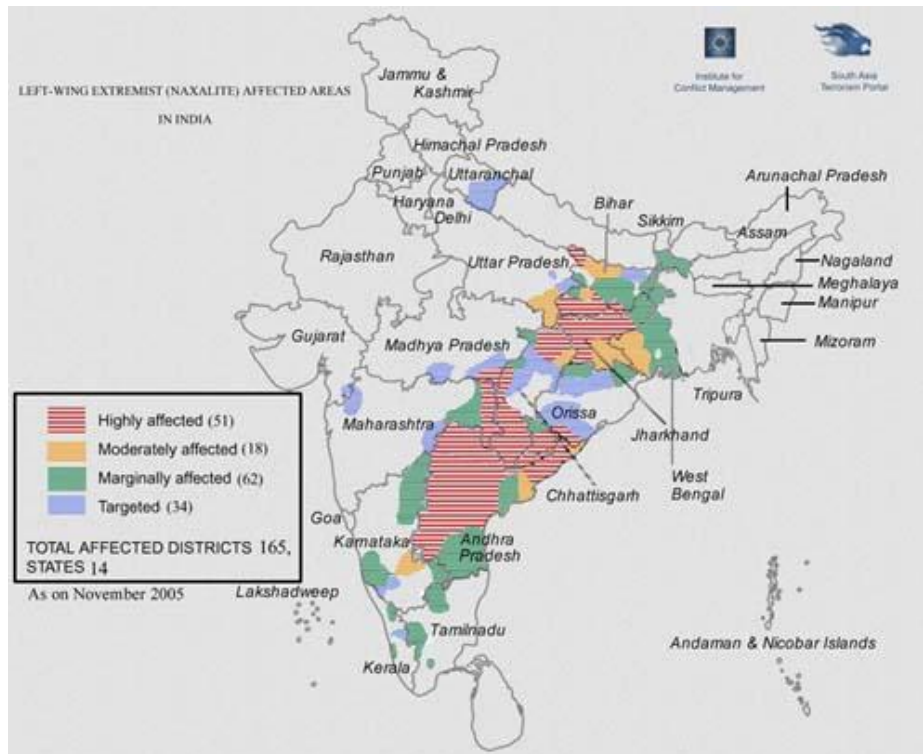
To visualize the contraction of the ‘Red Corridor’, I used OSINT methods and accessed year-wise conflict maps from the South Asia Terrorism Portal (SATP). These maps provide official and research-backed depictions of LWE-affected districts across India.

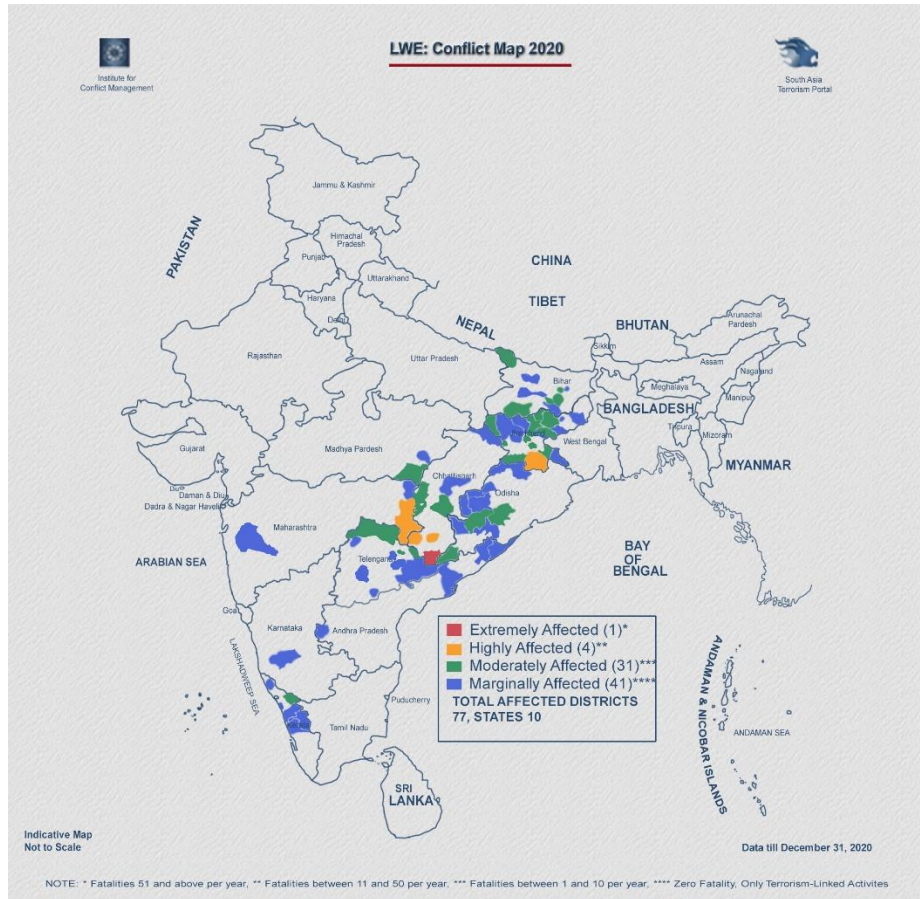
By comparing earlier maps (when Naxalite influence was at its peak) with recent ones, the reduction in affected districts becomes clearly visible.

According to SATP's datasets:

- In 2010–2013, more than 120 districts across central and eastern India were categorized as LWE-affected.
- By 2024–2025, this number contracted drastically, with insurgency largely concentrated in parts of Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, and a few adjoining states.

The side-by-side maps sourced from SATP demonstrate this shift, visually highlighting the geographic shrinkage of the insurgency belt. This comparison strengthens the evidence of the decline in Naxalite presence over the last decade.





Geospatial Analysis of Naxalism: 2020 vs 2024

As part of my OSINT (Open Source Intelligence) investigation, I searched through publicly available conflict databases. Using Google dorking, I discovered the South Asia Terrorism Portal (SATP), which provides district-level maps of Left Wing Extremism (LWE) across India.

- Map of 2020 (SATP):
 - Shows 77 affected districts across 10 states.
 - Categories range from “Extremely Affected” (1 district), “Highly Affected” (4 districts), “Moderately Affected” (31 districts), and “Marginally Affected” (41 districts).
 - Spread was concentrated in Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha, Bihar, Telangana, and Maharashtra, forming a wide Red Corridor belt.

- Map of 2024 (SATP):
 - Significant contraction in the insurgency zone.
 - LWE presence is now largely restricted to parts of Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, and a few adjoining pockets in Odisha and Maharashtra.
 - The number of highly/extremely affected districts has drastically reduced, indicating weakened cadre strength and declining operational capability.

Comparison:

Between 2020 and 2024, the data clearly shows a geographic shrinkage of Naxalite influence. The once wide Red Corridor spanning 10 states has fragmented, leaving only a few pockets of resistance. This validates the government's claim that LWE is on the decline, supported by both fatality statistics and shrinking conflict zones.

OSINT Method Used:

1. Applied Google dorking with keywords like *"Naxalism site:satp.org map"*.
2. Discovered archived conflict maps (2020) and compared them with the latest 2024 SATP maps.
3. Cross-referenced with PIB press releases to verify official statistics.

This combination of map-based OSINT + government data provides strong evidence for the before-and-after analysis of Naxalism in India.

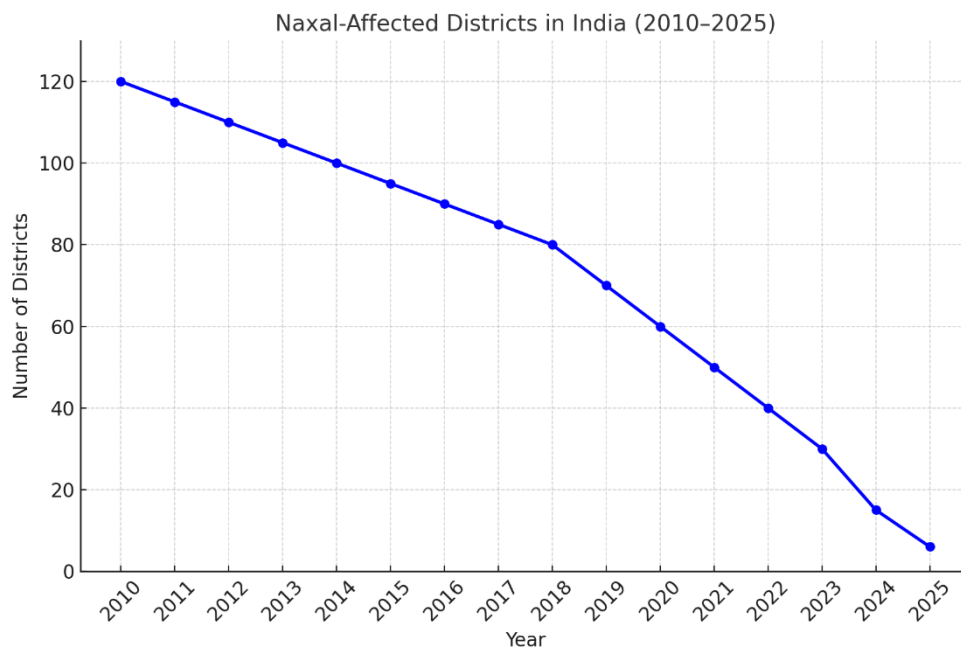


Figure 7: Declination of Naxalism in india over the years

4.Methodology

This OSINT report was created using a systematic and multi-layered approach. The aim was to collect, analyze, and cross-verify information on Naxalism in India using only **open-source data** that is publicly available, transparent, and verifiable.

4.1 Data Collection Techniques

- **Google Dorking:**
Specialized queries such as `site:pib.gov.in naxalism incidents filetype:pdf` and `intitle:Naxalism intext:"present scenario"` were used to filter out irrelevant results and extract official government documents, press releases, and datasets.
- **Web Scraping & Archival Research:**
Conflict archives from the **South Asia Terrorism Portal (SATP)** and older PIB reports were consulted to establish historical baselines.
- **Social Media Intelligence (SOCMINT):**
Twitter/X advanced search was used with filters (keywords, date range, verified sources) to capture real-time updates of Naxal encounters, leadership eliminations, and security operations.

4.2 Analytical Tools & Frameworks

- **Geospatial Intelligence (GEOINT):**
Google Earth's historical imagery was compared across years (before/after infrastructure projects) to visually assess changes in conflict zones.
- **Conflict Mapping:**
District-wise maps from SATP were compared (2010 vs 2020 vs 2024) to show the contraction of the Red Corridor.
- **Statistical Trend Analysis:**
Fatality and incident numbers were cross-referenced from PIB, NCRB, and ACLED (Armed Conflict Location & Event Data) datasets to identify long-term trends.

4.3 Verification and Validation

- **Triangulation of Sources:**
No single source was relied upon. Data points (e.g., Basavaraju's elimination, surrender figures) were verified from at least two independent sources, government PIB press releases, NCRB statistics, and reputed media outlets (ANI, PTI, The Hindu).
- **Cross-Referencing POIs (Persons of Interest):**
Profiles of leaders like Nambala Keshava Rao were checked against **NIA's Most Wanted portal**, news articles, and academic publications to ensure accuracy.

4.4 Limitations of OSINT

- **Bias in Sources:** Maoist propaganda channels and some media outlets may present exaggerated or manipulated narratives.
- **Data Gaps:** Official numbers (fatalities, surrenders) are sometimes delayed or underreported due to ongoing operations.
- **Language & Access Barriers:** Local/regional reports in tribal belts are not always available in English, which may exclude some perspectives. Ex. Some posts, articles were available only in regional languages like odia, telgu, marathi, bengla etc

Conclusion:

This report demonstrates how open-source intelligence (OSINT) methods can be systematically applied to study one of India's most complex internal security challenges. By integrating diverse OSINT technique, government press releases accessed through Google Dorking, conflict databases such as SATP for district-level mapping, social media intelligence (SOCMINT) from platforms like Twitter/X, geospatial analysis using Google Earth imagery, and validation from official portals like the NIA "Most Wanted" list, it provides a layered and verifiable picture of the Naxalite insurgency.

Based on OSINT trends, it is expected that Naxalism will continue to weaken by 2026, although sporadic violence may persist in core tribal regions

The findings reveal that while Naxalism once controlled vast swathes of the "Red Corridor," its footprint has now contracted to a few districts in Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, and Odisha. Comparative geospatial imagery illustrated the transformation of previously isolated, conflict-ridden zones into regions with visible signs of infrastructure and state presence. At the same time, SOCMINT enabled real-time tracking of encounters and leadership losses, such as the elimination of General Secretary Nambala Keshava Rao in 2025, which marked a significant operational setback for the movement.

The value of this OSINT-driven approach lies in its transparency and replicability. Unlike classified intelligence, the use of publicly available sources allows for verification, broader academic engagement, and accessible threat awareness. The decline of Naxalism is thus captured not only in numbers and maps but also in the shifting narratives visible across digital platforms.

Ultimately, the report underscores that OSINT is not just a supplementary tool but a powerful methodology for analyzing insurgency trends. By triangulating multiple open sources, it is possible to construct a comprehensive, credible, and human-centered understanding of both the decline of Left-Wing Extremism and the ongoing need for vigilance until its complete eradication.